



Design and establish a training system

D2.TRD.CL8.05

Trainee Manual



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Introduction to trainee manual

To the Trainee

Congratulations on joining this course. This Trainee Manual is one part of a 'toolbox' which is a resource provided to trainees, trainers and assessors to help you become competent in various areas of your work.

The 'toolbox' consists of three elements:

- A Trainee Manual for you to read and study at home or in class
- A Trainer Guide with Power Point slides to help your Trainer explain the content of the training material and provide class activities to help with practice
- An Assessment Manual which provides your Assessor with oral and written questions and other assessment tasks to establish whether or not you have achieved competency.

The first thing you may notice is that this training program and the information you find in the Trainee Manual seems different to the textbooks you have used previously. This is because the method of instruction and examination is different. The method used is called Competency based training (CBT) and Competency based assessment (CBA). CBT and CBA is the training and assessment system chosen by ASEAN (Association of South-East Asian Nations) to train people to work in the tourism and hospitality industry throughout all the ASEAN member states.

What is the CBT and CBA system and why has it been adopted by ASEAN?

CBT is a way of training that concentrates on what a worker can do or is required to do at work. The aim of the training is to enable trainees to perform tasks and duties at a standard expected by employers. CBT seeks to develop the skills, knowledge and attitudes (or recognise the ones the trainee already possesses) to achieve the required competency standard. ASEAN has adopted the CBT/CBA training system as it is able to produce the type of worker that industry is looking for and this therefore increases trainee chances of obtaining employment.

CBA involves collecting evidence and making a judgement of the extent to which a worker can perform his/her duties at the required competency standard. Where a trainee can already demonstrate a degree of competency, either due to prior training or work experience, a process of 'Recognition of Prior Learning' (RPL) is available to trainees to recognise this. Please speak to your trainer about RPL if you think this applies to you.

What is a competency standard?

Competency standards are descriptions of the skills and knowledge required to perform a task or activity at the level of a required standard.

242 competency standards for the tourism and hospitality industries throughout the ASEAN region have been developed to cover all the knowledge, skills and attitudes required to work in the following occupational areas:

- Housekeeping
- Food Production
- Food and Beverage Service
- Front Office

- Travel Agencies
- Tour Operations.

All of these competency standards are available for you to look at. In fact you will find a summary of each one at the beginning of each Trainee Manual under the heading 'Unit Descriptor'. The unit descriptor describes the content of the unit you will be studying in the Trainee Manual and provides a table of contents which are divided up into 'Elements' and 'Performance Criteria'. An element is a description of one aspect of what has to be achieved in the workplace. The 'Performance Criteria' below each element details the level of performance that needs to be demonstrated to be declared competent.

There are other components of the competency standard:

- *Unit Title*: statement about what is to be done in the workplace
- *Unit Number*: unique number identifying the particular competency
- *Nominal hours*: number of classroom or practical hours usually needed to complete the competency. We call them 'nominal' hours because they can vary e.g. sometimes it will take an individual less time to complete a unit of competency because he/she has prior knowledge or work experience in that area.

The final heading you will see before you start reading the Trainee Manual is the 'Assessment Matrix'. Competency based assessment requires trainees to be assessed in at least 2 – 3 different ways, one of which must be practical. This section outlines three ways assessment can be carried out and includes work projects, written questions and oral questions. The matrix is designed to show you which performance criteria will be assessed and how they will be assessed. Your trainer and/or assessor may also use other assessment methods including 'Observation Checklist' and 'Third Party Statement'. An observation checklist is a way of recording how you perform at work and a third party statement is a statement by a supervisor or employer about the degree of competence they believe you have achieved. This can be based on observing your workplace performance, inspecting your work or gaining feedback from fellow workers.

Your trainer and/or assessor may use other methods to assess you such as:

- Journals
- Oral presentations
- Role plays
- Log books
- Group projects
- Practical demonstrations.

Remember your trainer is there to help you succeed and become competent. Please feel free to ask him or her for more explanation of what you have just read and of what is expected from you and best wishes for your future studies and future career in tourism and hospitality.

Unit descriptor

Design and establish a training system

This unit deals with the skills and knowledge required to Design and establish a training system in a range of settings within the hotel and travel industries workplace context.

Unit Code:

D2.TRD.CL8.05

Nominal Hours:

100 hours

Element 1: Determine the features of a workplace training system

Performance Criteria

- 1.1 Identify key operational features and constraints of the workplace training system
- 1.2 Research enterprise requirements in relation to the workplace training system
- 1.3 Identify the legal and other requirements that apply to the establishment and operation of the workplace training system
- 1.4 Document and verify identified operational features and constraints of the workplace training system
- 1.5 Establish and maintain relationships with key stakeholders
- 1.6 Identify the resources available to support the identified workplace training system requirements

Element 2: Align workplace training needs with required resources

Performance Criteria

- 2.1 Match human resources to identified workplace training needs
- 2.2 Match physical resources to identified workplace training needs
- 2.3 Match financial resources to identified workplace training needs
- 2.4 Identify external funding sources for the workplace training system
- 2.5 Prepare a budget for the workplace training system
- 2.6 Obtain management commitment to the workplace training system
- 2.7 Identify sources of provision for workplace training materials and delivery

Element 3: Develop workplace training system documents

Performance Criteria

- 3.1 Develop training policies and procedures to support implementation and operation of the workplace training system
- 3.2 Identify record keeping requirements within the identified workplace training system
- 3.3 Produce operational training system forms to support and record workplace training delivery

Element 4: Establish procedures for the review of the workplace training system

Performance Criteria

- 4.1 Identify the elements of the workplace training system to be reviewed
- 4.2 Determine the frequency for reviewing identified elements within the workplace training system
- 4.3 Allocate responsibility for implementing identified reviews of the workplace training system
- 4.4 Describe the procedures to be used in the review of the workplace training system
- 4.5 Document approved procedures for review of the workplace training system
- 4.6 Obtain management commitment to implement required changes to the workplace training system

Element 5: Prepare to implement the workplace training system

Performance Criteria

- 5.1 Develop an implementation plan for the training system
- 5.2 Prepare trainers and assessors in accordance with identified need
- 5.3 Prepare training programs to provide identified training
- 5.4 Obtain resources to support training delivery
- 5.5 Recruit participants for training

Element 6: Establish quality assurance procedures for the workplace training system

Performance Criteria

- 6.1 Establish a quality assurance group
- 6.2 Document draft verification processes that the quality assurance group will undertake
- 6.3 Trial the draft quality assurance procedures
- 6.4 Advise trainers in relation to established and confirmed quality assurance procedures

Assessment matrix

Showing mapping of Performance Criteria against Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions

The Assessment Matrix indicates three of the most common assessment activities your Assessor may use to assess your understanding of the content of this manual and your performance - Work Projects, Written Questions and Oral Questions. It also indicates where you can find the subject content related to these assessment activities in the Trainee Manual (i.e. under which element or performance criteria). As explained in the Introduction, however, the assessors are free to choose which assessment activities are most suitable to best capture evidence of competency as they deem appropriate for individual students.

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 1: Determine the features of a workplace training system				
1.1	Identify key operational features and constraints of the workplace training system	1.1	1, 2	1
1.2	Research enterprise requirements in relation to the workplace training system	1.1	3 – 6	2
1.3	Identify the legal and other requirements that apply to the establishment and operation of the workplace training system	1.1	7	3
1.4	Document and verify identified operational features and constraints of the workplace training system	1.1	8, 9	4, 7, 8
1.5	Establish and maintain relationships with key stakeholders	1.1	10, 11	5
1.6	Identify the resources available to support the identified workplace training system requirements	1.1	12, 13	6
Element 2: Align workplace training needs with required resources				
2.1	Match human resources to identified workplace training needs	2.1	14	9
2.2	Match physical resources to identified workplace training needs	2.1	15, 16	9
2.3	Match financial resources to identified workplace training needs	2.1	17	9
2.4	Identify external funding sources for the workplace training system	2.1	18	10

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
2.5	Prepare a budget for the workplace training system	2.1	19, 20	11
2.6	Obtain management commitment to the workplace training system	2.1	21	12
2.7	Identify sources of provision for workplace training materials and delivery	2.1	22	13
Element 3: Develop workplace training system documents				
3.1	Develop training policies and procedures to support implementation and operation of the workplace training system	3.1	23, 24, 25	14
3.2	Identify record keeping requirements within the identified workplace training system	3.1	26, 27	15
3.3	Produce operational training system forms to support and record workplace training delivery	3.1	28, 29	16
Element 4: Establish procedures for the review of the workplace training system				
4.1	Identify the elements of the workplace training system to be reviewed	4.1	30, 31	17
4.2	Determine the frequency for reviewing identified elements within the workplace training system	4.1	32	17
4.3	Allocate responsibility for implementing identified reviews of the workplace training system	4.1	33, 34, 35	17
4.4	Describe the procedures to be used in the review of the workplace training system	4.1	36 – 39	18
4.5	Document approved procedures for review of the workplace training system	4.1	40, 41	18
4.6	Obtain management commitment to implement required changes to the workplace training system	4.1	42, 43	19

		Work Projects	Written Questions	Oral Questions
Element 5: Prepare to implement the workplace training system				
5.1	Develop an implementation plan for the training system	5.1	44, 45	20
5.2	Prepare trainers and assessors in accordance with identified need	5.1	46, 47	21
5.3	Prepare training programs to provide identified training	5.1	48 – 54	21
5.4	Obtain resources to support training delivery	5.1	55, 56	22
5.5	Recruit participants for training	5.1	57	22
Element 6: Establish quality assurance procedures for the workplace training system				
6.1	Establish a quality assurance group	6.1	58 – 61	23
6.2	Document draft verification processes that the quality assurance group will undertake	6.1	62, 63	24
6.3	Trial the draft quality assurance procedures	6.1	64	24
6.4	Advise trainers in relation to established and confirmed quality assurance procedures	6.1	65, 66	25

Glossary

Term	Explanation
ASQA	Australian Skills Quality Authority
ATO	Accredited Training Organisation
Assessment plan	Plan for the assessment of an individual candidate
C	Competent (as opposed to NYC)
CBA	Competency Based Assessment
CBT	Competency Based Training
CEO	Chief Executive Officer
CQI	Continuous Quality Improvement
Candidate	A person to be assessed
Consumables	Items used ('consumed') as part of training and assessment processes and practices
Cross-skilled employees	Workers who can perform two major roles/fill two primary positions
DIRKS	Designing and Implementing Record Keeping Systems
External customers	Paying customers who spend money with the business
FAQs	Frequently Asked Questions
IT	Information Technology
Internal customers	Staff working in the organisation who are served by other staff
KPI	Key Performance Indicator
LRC	Learning Resource Centre
Learner	A person who will participate in training
Milestone	Date by which a significant action is expected to be completed

Term	Explanation
Multi-skilled employees	Staff skilled/proficient in a variety of work roles
NYC	Not Yet Competent
<i>Per diem</i> allowance	(Latin) Per day/daily allowance for living away from home/out-of-pocket expenses
PESTEL analysis	Same as SLEPT analysis with addition of Environmental factors
Primary data	New/fresh information generated as a result of new research activities
<i>Pro forma</i>	Template document
QA	Quality Assurance
QMS	Quality Management System
Quantitative data	Statistical data: also known as hard data
Qualitative data	Answers the 'why' questions: also known as soft data
RCC	Recognition of Current Competencies
ROI	Return On Investment
RPL	Recognition of Prior Learning
RTO	Registered Training Organisation
Refresher training	Training provided to maintain currency of skills, knowledge and/or certification
SLEPT analysis	Analysis of a situation looking at the Social, Legal, economic, political and technological factors
STEEPLE analysis	Same as PESTEL analysis with addition of ethical factors
SWOT	Strengths, Weaknesses, Opportunities and Threats
Scope of Registration	The list of qualifications a recognised training has been approved to deliver – they may only deliver qualifications which are on their Scope of Registration
Secondary data	Data/information which already exists in reports, databases, business documentation or in other sources

Term	Explanation
Session plan	Plan showing how individual lessons/training sessions will be conducted
Soft copy	Electronic format/copy
Stakeholders	People/organisations with a stake/interest in a decision or project
Statement of Attainment	Formal document issued by an RTO/ATO stating the person named on the document has completed the training/competency standards listed – provided where a person does not complete a full qualification
TAFE	Technical and Further Education
TNA	Training Needs Analysis
Training gap	Difference between what staff should be able to do/know and what they can do/know
Training plan	Plan for the training of an individual learner

Element 1:

Determine the features of a workplace training system

1.1 Identify key operational features and constraints of the workplace training system

Introduction

An important starting point when determining the features of a workplace training system is to identify its key operational features and to determine the constraints which will apply to the system.

This section sets out a number of important points to note when determining the features for a workplace training system which is to be established, identifies key possible stakeholders, presents an overview of what is meant by a workplace training system, discusses a wide range of operational features which must be considered when designing and setting up the system, and describes traditional constraints which also need to be factored in.



Important points to note

When working to determine the features of/for a workplace training system which is to be established it is worth noting the following points:

- Use a team approach – there should be a dedicated group of people who undertake the research and investigations required
 - It is not recommended that one person does all the work in this regard. A team approach:
 - Allows the workload to be shared
 - Gives the opportunity for ideas and information to be debated and ‘tested’ by others in the group
 - Decreases the time line needed for the overall research and development phase
- Be prepared to work in a difficult and fraught environment – when researching information to use as the basis for determining the features of a new workplace training system to be established, there will often be:
 - Changes over time in the opinions, ideas, needs, wants and preferences of the stakeholders
 - Changes in the operational parameters within which the system is expected to function

- Conflict between stakeholders regarding which of various options available (such as, but not limited to, structural issue, delivery methodologies, operational protocols, content) should be selected as the one/s which will be used/applied in the final manifestation of the system
- Situations where decisions have to be made but there appears to be insufficient information to make a genuinely informed decision
- Confusion over a diverse range of very important topics – because there is frequently different/conflicting advice provided by:
 - Industry experts
 - Government officers and industry representatives
 - Other organisations that have developed, and continue to operate, their own training system

For example, it can often be difficult (and **sometimes impossible**) to determine definitive answers to many of what seem quite basic questions:

- What legislated requirements really apply to establishing a system?
 - What does the company expect the system to do/achieve?
 - How much will the system cost to set up and operate?
 - When should it start operating?
 - What should be taught?
- Document everything – in relation to:
 - Information obtained
 - Decisions made and reasons for same
 - Actions/research undertaken.
- See more in section 1.4.



Key stakeholders

Stakeholders in the design and establishment of a workplace training system will vary depending on:

- Company size and structure
- Whether or not the organisation wants to be a recognised training provider or not
- Partnership arrangements and working agreements which exist between the organisation and other businesses.

In overview key stakeholders may include:

- Business owners
- The Board of Management within the organisation
- Industry, professional and trade associations and bodies
- Qualified trainers and assessors
- Team leaders, supervisors and managers
- Training participants and employees – past and present
- Technical experts
- Union representatives
- Consultative committees within the business
- Relevant industry training providers and associated training agencies.



Operational features

The initial starting point for the development of any workplace training system must be the canvassing and consideration of all the operational features the system is expected to function within.

Operational features may include:

- Purpose of and identified outcomes for the training
- Scope of the training system
- Minimum requirements for training system staff
- Record keeping requirements
- Characteristics of training participants
- Legislated requirements
- Allocation of fees and costs
- Review and evaluation processes
- Promotion of the training system.

Purpose of and identified outcomes for the training

The purpose of and identified outcomes for the training will directly relate to the primary reasons the organisation has decided to establish its own training system and will likely embrace diverse factors.

Issues commonly inherent in this consideration are:

- Desire for increased productivity – for the items produced and services provided by the business
- Need for identification and development of *new* products and services – which can be introduced to the service/product menu
- Need for identification of *existing* products and services – which require revision and/or modification/updating in order for them to remain viable, attractive or competitive

- Talent pool available to the business – taking into account:
 - Current availability of suitably trained and experienced staff
 - Projected levels of availability – as gauged against:
 - Anticipated activity levels for the business
 - Strategic directions the organisation expects to take
- Planned business objective to have a set percentage of the workforce fully-trained in set competencies by a given date – as part of, for example:
 - An internal target
 - A legislated compliance issue
- Requirement to specify criteria for *evaluating* increases in productivity – so an informed decision can be made regarding the overall/balanced value attaching to any productivity increases gained

For example, business will not accept productivity increases at the cost of increased injury to workers, rising breaches of relevant legislation or damaging public sentiment towards the business
- Demand for increased profitability – as a result of (for example):
 - Lower costs as a result of training which has introduced new/better practices
 - Efficiencies flowing from a better trained workforce
 - Greater work-based synergies
- Objective of attaining specific industry or enterprise competencies and/or standards – including:
 - Alignment of training outcomes with internally or externally imposed competency attainment requirements for the standardised delivery of service and production of products
 - Meeting (or exceeding) levels of competency offered/demonstrated by competitors
- Need to achieve business goals and priorities – which are often involved with:
 - Enabling employees to attain objectives contained in high-level business plans and organisational strategic plans
 - Training workers to implement the requirements of lower-level operating plans
- Necessity of compliance with externally-imposed requirements – such as:
 - Mandatory legislated obligations
 - Operational imperatives required by applicable Codes of Practice and Quality Assurance/Management Systems and registration Standards (set by national Training Authorities)
 - Contractual obligations imposed by business partnerships/relationships with other organisations



- Need for the system to align with planned human resources considerations – such as:
 - Staffing levels
 - Remuneration levels
 - Promotion strategies
 - Contingency planning for operations
 - Succession planning
 - Personal development strategies and targets
- Need for the system to handle induction training – to:
 - Initiate new staff into the organisation
 - Provide basic operational skills and knowledge
- Requirement the system provide refresher training – including:
 - Scheduled training updates to maintain currency of skills and knowledge
 - Re-accreditation requirements
 - Targeted training to enhance competency levels of individual employees
 - Maintenance of currency for work-related certificates, permits, licences and qualifications.



Scope of the training system

Scope of the training system can force the organisation to determine matters such as:

- Training orientation to be used by the business – with reference to whether or not the enterprise elects to follow the principles of:
 - CBT
 - CBA
 - Face-to-face training and/or assessment
 - Online training and/or assessment
- Sites the training system will operate from – with traditional options including:
 - Operating out of one/single business premises
 - Running multiple training sites at different locations/branches/offices
 - Using a national site/training facility
 - Training through a network of international sites in different countries so local in-country businesses can be serviced
- Physical location of training to be conducted in the workplace – with reference to, for example:
 - On-the-job training – undertaken physically at each work station with no formal training room
 - Off-the-job – where the training occurs in the workplace but takes place in a training room set aside for the purpose of training delivery and assessment purposes

- Off-site training – where the training may be provided by, and in the rooms of:
 - A registered/accredited provider
 - An industry body
 - A non-accredited third party provider – such as a carrier or supplier with whom the organisation does business
- Number of expected students/employees the system is expected to train – and consideration of their status in terms of whether they are:
 - New employees with no experience and/or qualifications
 - New employees with experience but no required qualifications
 - New employees with qualifications but no experience
- Content and/or breadth of the training to be delivered – in terms of:
 - Type of qualifications to be delivered
 - Level of qualifications
 - Roles/positions to be trained
 - Development of draft offerings, courses, units or training topics to be made available
 - Preparation of draft timetables to guide tentative training delivery and assessment activities
- Determination of ancillary recognition arrangements, where applicable – including requirements to enable:
 - In-house training provision to be recognised by external training and other industry bodies
 - RPL
 - RCC
- Profile of student cohort – with reference to:
 - Whether all learners are employees of the organisation
 - Whether the organisation offers training to the public/people from outside the organisation
- Operational training status of the organisation – which will require consideration of decisions about the business in terms of whether the training system is to:
 - Become registered as a registered/accredited training provider in its own right
 - Operate as an unrecognised/non-accredited training provider – still delivering quality training but (nonetheless) training which is not acknowledged by any formal structure within the country
 - Function under a partnership arrangement with joint-venture partners – who will wish to determine/influence training content, methodology for delivery and assessment, operational training status, resourcing and many other day-to-day operational protocols



- Operational method/s to be used by the system – such as whether it features:
 - Use of accredited training programs/courses
 - Use of national and/or international benchmarks and programs
 - Using internal and/or external learning resources
 - Product-based training
 - A combination of the above.



Minimum requirements for training system staff

Minimum requirements for training system staff must address:

- Establishing minimum requirements for competencies and certification of trainers
- Establishing minimum requirements for competencies and certification of assessors
- Calculating number of training staff required
- Determining necessary experience required for trainers and assessors
- Addressing whether trainers and assessors will be employed by the organisation or whether their services will be obtained through third party registered/accredited training organisations.

Record keeping requirements

Considerations in this regard must centre on the following:

- Integration of the generation and maintenance of training records with other internal documentation
- Identification of statistics and other information required from the records to assist with operational and financial decision making regarding implementation of the training system
- Determination of externally-imposed record keeping demands made by government authorities – if the organisation is a registered/accredited training organisation
- Recording attendance at training and assessment sessions of all learners and candidates
- Identification and/or development of sample documentation
- Creation or identification of policies and procedures to underpin operation of the record keeping system
- Training context requirements, including procedures to match identified competencies with designated training programs/qualifications
- Capacity of the system to identify staff who have potential for promotion/extra responsibilities as well as those who require extra attention or who may be problematic.

Characteristics of training participants

Characteristics of training participants may include:

- History of learners – with reference to:
 - Length of service with organisation
 - Details of type and nature of previous engagement with training
 - Outcomes/results of previous training
- Identification of individual differences that may affect training delivery – such as issues relating to:
 - Known or likely language, literacy and numeracy needs of learners
 - The anticipated or known cultural factors and educational background
 - Gender and age of learners
 - Physical abilities and/or disabilities which are expected/need to be accommodated
 - Workplace experience with the training topics
 - Preferred learning styles
 - Work, family, social and out-of-work commitments
 - Motivation learners are known or expected to have to undertake training
- Allowable adjustments to training assessment – to accommodate:
 - Use of aides to assist special needs employees
 - Language issues
 - Literacy and/or numeracy problems.



Legislated requirements

Legislated requirements can relate to:

- Legal obligations imposed by all countries where the organisation operates its training system
- Industrial relations and employment-related issues as they affect training provision by the employer
- Responsibilities relating to:
 - Compliance with workplace safety
 - Need to train employees in workplace safety
 - Mandated workplace licensing requirements
- Compulsory equal opportunity requirements – in terms of:
 - Providing access to training for all employees
 - Accommodating social justice programs
 - Opening the potential for merit-based advancement/promotion to all workers.

Allocation of fees and costs

Allocation of fees and costs commonly requires attention be paid to:

- Legal requirements applying to organisations prohibiting them for charging for training which is specifically work-related
- Business opportunities provided by the capacity of the organisation to act as a training provider for other businesses and/or for individuals wanting to obtain industry skills, knowledge and/or (if appropriate) certification and qualifications
- Identification of possible funding options for vocational training and assessment from government and non-government sources
- Accountability for public money (grants, subsidies) obtained from the government and/or other funding supplied by industry-based organisations
- Determination/estimation of expenses associated with ancillary training-related costs – which may include:
 - Payments to employees to register/enrol in other institutions
 - Extra wage costs for back-filling employees who are attending training and cannot undertake normal duties
 - Additional remuneration to be paid when workers attain nominated certificates or competencies
- Impact on the positive image/customer perception of the business also operating as a training institute in the marketplace
- Purchase of initial equipment and resources to initiate the system
- Supplementation of funds to enable ongoing sustainability of the system
- Internal budgets, budget lines and protocols for allocating funding and resources to training delivery and assessments
- Determination of fees and charges for proposed courses
- Establishment of supporting policies to control payment of fees, deposits, cancellations, reimbursement to staff (for example when they successfully complete a course).



Review and evaluation

Review and evaluation of the system requires determination of:

- Standard periodic reporting procedures – during the everyday operation of the system and at distinct points (such as monthly, or at the end of course, certificate/group)
- Topics which need to be the focus for review and evaluation – such as:
 - Performance of trainers and assessors
 - Training outcomes/results
 - Content
 - Delivery and assessment methods used
 - Resources used to support/enable training and assessment
 - Learner satisfaction levels with the system

- Methodology for gaining user-feedback – from:
 - Learners/students
 - Trainers and assessors within the system
 - Supervisors and co-workers of those who have been trained by the system
 - Customers who have been swerved by those who have completed organisational training
- Frequency of reviews
- Nature of the review/s to be conducted
- Personnel involved in the review process
- Criteria/KPIs against which the training system will be evaluated
- Consideration of integration of review and evaluation findings into the ongoing development and maintenance of the training system.



Promotion of the training system

Promotion of the training system involves decision making regarding:

- Establishment of a formal and distinct 'Training' department within the organisation – to give training a visible presence and identifiable profile
- Creation of a range of strategies designed to proactively contact potential learners – in terms of:
 - Notifying current employees about the internal training system and what it has to offer
 - Communicating with school leavers – to highlight what the business has to offer them
 - Speaking to external bodies/groups about the workplace training system
 - Generating promotional brochures/materials to advertise the training available and generate interest
 - Making 'training' a standing topic at all staff meetings
- Identification and selling of the benefits of training to current employees and future potential learners
- Facilitation of the delivery of training by authorising changes to rosters that will maximise participation by employees in scheduled classes
- Provision of training information to potential learners in a timely fashion – such as:
 - At interview
 - When signing Letter of Offer/employment contract
 - During induction and orientation
 - As part of standard performance appraisal activities within the organisation
- Recognition of achievements of those who have engaged with workplace training – in some form that is valuable to the individual and to the workforce in general

- Industry/trade competitions the business intends to participate in – so as to:
 - Challenge learners
 - Gain exposure and recognition for the internal training system
 - Demonstrate the competency of organisational employees in a public forum
- Co-operation with other training providers – to:
 - Assist them with their training and assessment activities
 - Expose organisational learners to alternate practices
 - Develop the status of the organisation as a reputable and credible training provider
- Demonstration of the value and benefit of training – by:
 - Engaging/hiring staff with a nominated basic level of training
 - Promoting staff from inside the business who have completed training relevant to the position
- Communication with the media and identified stakeholders – to:
 - Advise them of training-related milestones and outcomes
 - Celebrate successes and the completion of courses
 - Keep the organisation name foremost in the mind of potential employees as a preferred employer.



Constraints

Background

As well as identifying the key operational features of the proposed training system there is a concurrent requirement to also determine the constraints which apply to the establishment of the system.

In relation to constraints:

- Determination of the constraints will not always be a *separate activity* to the definition of the features of the system – indeed, many constraints will emerge as the features are considered, discussed and identified
- Some features will also be constraints – and may exist as issues/topics under both headings
 - For example:
 - Locations where the training system will be implemented will, of necessity, be both a feature of the system and also a constraint
 - Student/learner numbers will again be a feature as well as a limiting factor
- Many constraints are time-specific – meaning a constraint can exist as such ‘now’ but may change in the future, either becoming less of a restriction or even more of a constraint
- All organisations will have some form of constraints applicable to them – there is never total freedom to establish ‘whatever is needed’.

Examples

Constraints which might apply to a workplace training system may include:

- Time available for training – including:
 - Location of time within the operational context of the business – to ensure the required levels/standards of customer service are retained while training occurs
 - Fitting required training into the staffing rosters of the business – as it is usually a legal requirement for training to take place during paid work hours
- Budgetary considerations in relation to limitations may include:
 - Increased/unacceptable total costs
 - Low levels of available funds
 - Grants tied to nominated training outcomes and not available for general training use – or funding tied to successful outcomes/completion rates
 - Cost of borrowing
 - Decreased ROI
- Ancillary cost constraints – as they impact the provision of training will relate to:
 - Impact of less-than-favourable results of cost-benefit-analysis undertaken in relation to **not** providing training for employees
 - Opportunity costs associated with/flowing from time, space and money spent on training – as opposed to spending the same time, space and money on some other initiative
 - Lower than acceptable potential returns on investment from delivering training to employees – seen as a benefit/asset to the organisation
 - Unacceptable/excessive direct and indirect costs that apply – in conjunction with:
 - Totals involved
 - Impact on taxation claims/deductions which can or cannot be made
 - Timing of identifiable expenses in terms of cash flow for the organisation
- Geographical issues – which may encompass:
 - Limits imposed by the costs involved for trainers and assessors to travel to training destinations
 - Restrictions caused through the cost of sending learners to remote locations
 - Constraints as a result of accommodation and associated costs – such as *per diem* allowances
 - Caps on time available for travelling – where travel time has to be paid
 - Language issues requiring extra expense in terms of translation of documents and preparation of materials in multiple languages



- Physical resources limits can relate to:
 - Need to confine training and assessment to using only the *existing* workplace materials, equipment and technology
 - Requirement to analyse and evaluate training items, programs and supporting resources to ensure they are suitable to use in terms of safety and reflecting what is actually used in the workplace – and limits which apply to acquiring new or additional resources
 - Inability to obtain/source required resources – within the funding envelope allocated to this process
- Availability of appropriate staff may be a constraint with reference to situations where:
 - There are insufficient qualified trainers and assessors
 - There is a lack of personnel with suitable industry and/or training-related experience
 - Trainers and assessors are demanding excessive remuneration
 - Employees within the business are not motivated to become involved in training and assessment
 - Employees who take on training and assessment responsibilities are not given a realistic sufficient time allocation to undertake those duties in a professional manner
- Unrealistic management expectations – in terms of:
 - Numbers required to be trained
 - Breadth of training courses to be conducted
 - Depth of skills and knowledge to be delivered
 - Time, funding and resource allocation/s
 - Target completion dates.



Websites

It may be useful at this stage to take time to read the websites below – while they are Australian-based government compliance issues they nonetheless provide information which can be transferred to other countries and applied to workplace-based, non-accredited training systems.

<http://www.serviceskills.com.au/becoming-a-registered-training-organisation> - Becoming a registered training organisation

<http://www.rtosupport.com.au/rto-support-services/prospective-rtos> - Prospective RTOs: thinking of becoming an RTO?

<http://www.asqa.gov.au/vet-registration/understand-the-requirements-for-registration/understand-the-requirements-for-registration.html> - Understand the requirements for registration

<http://www.comlaw.gov.au/Details/F2015L01377> - Standards for RTOs 2015

<http://vanguardvisions.com.au/six-steps-to-successfully-implementing-workplace-online-training/> - Six steps to successfully implementing workplace online training

<http://www.ncver.edu.au/wps/wcm/connect/827bfae5-2630-4b8f-a0fa-29e31a4c3f86/nr9013.pdf?MOD=AJPERES&CACHEID=827bfae5-2630-4b8f-a0fa-29e31a4c3f86> - Factors influencing the implementation of training and learning in the workplace (ANTA/NCVER publication) [Australian National Training Authority/National Centre for Vocational Education Research]

1.2 Research enterprise requirements in relation to the workplace training system

Introduction

Enterprise-specific requirements for a proposed workplace training system must be researched following initial identification of the (projected/anticipated) features and constraints for any workplace training system.

This section identifies a range of principles together with practical activities which have proved to be effective in researching specific workplace needs.



Doing qualitative and quantitative research

Doing qualitative and quantitative research involves:

- Conducting qualitative research which will reveal 'soft data':
 - Answers to 'why' questions
 - Thoughts and ideas
 - Reasons and causes
 - Non-numerical information
- Performing quantitative research which aims to unveil 'hard data':
 - Figures and statistics
 - Numerical data
 - Information which can be transformed into numbers, ratios, percentages
 - Anything that can be quantified.

Doing secondary and primary research

Secondary research is research into existing information.

It is done by:

- Analysing internal accounting books
- Reading management reports
- Reviewing previous research undertaken

Primary research is research generating new information.

It generates information to address holes in the research left as a consequence of the secondary research.

It is done by:

- Talking to people/interviewing them
- Administering questionnaires
- Observing practice
- Doing TNAs and skills audits and analyses.

Undertaking specific workplace analysis

Workplace analysis may also be performed using one of a range of other options.

SWOT analysis

A SWOT analysis is the process of gathering together information/data on both the internal and external environments of the organisation to determine the strengths, weaknesses, opportunities that are present as well as the threats relating to the situation being considered – in this case, the establishment of a workplace training system.

A SWOT analysis is a fundamental pre-requisite for any research to help determine the situation being considered.

A SWOT analysis may also be known as:

- A Situational analysis
- A Situation analysis
- A SWOT matrix.

Internal factors

The internal factors in a SWOT analysis are the factors present within the organisation.

They are the 'Strengths' and 'Weaknesses' of the entity.

What is a strength for one business may well be a weakness for another.

For example:

- One business may have loads of cash reserved to fund the establishment of a training system, while another could be cash-poor
- One organisation may have a detailed knowledge of the formal in-country vocational training system while another operator knows little/nothing in this regard.

To an extent these factors are controllable as the organisations have the power to impact them – they can (for example) take action to raise more money or obtain additional resources and work to gain more experience regarding their national training system.

External factors

External factors are those which exist outside the business.

They are divided into:

- Opportunities – which are factors which can be exploited or taken advantage of in relation to the establishment of the training system
- Threats – which represent things which might prejudice, jeopardise or otherwise negatively influence the establishment of the training system

Some threats cannot be effectively addressed.

External factors are regarded as being uncontrollable in that the business/entity undertaking the research is unable to (significantly) impact the relevant factors.



Other approaches

Other ways to view/consider the external factors impacting a business are to use SLEPT or PESTEL analysis of the situation.

SLEPT analysis involves consideration of:

- Social factors
- Legal factors
- Economic factors
- Political factors
- Technological factors.

PESTEL analysis is the same as SLEPT but with the addition of 'Environmental' factors.

STEEPLE analysis adds consideration of Ethics.

Websites

Take time to read articles as follows:

http://www.mindtools.com/pages/article/newTMC_05.htm - SWOT analysis

<http://smallbusiness.chron.com/swot-analysis-diversity-training-1850.html> - SWOT analysis on diversity training

<http://pestleanalysis.com/> - PESTLE analysis

<http://www.slideshare.net/lconner/steeple> - STEEPLE analysis.



Analysing market trends

In this context 'analysing market trends' may refer to:

- Looking at the employment market to try to identify areas/jobs where there is a lack of suitably qualified and experienced staff
- Reviewing the employment/unemployment rates for the catchment area from which employees are traditionally sourced
- Determining the roles and positions that ATOs/RTOs are currently providing suitable and sufficient training for – and for which, therefore, there is less need to provide workplace training
- Attempting to predict the future – in terms of:
 - Identifying the work which will need to be undertaken in the business in order to achieve business and strategic goals
 - Determining equipment and technology with which future staff will need to be competent
 - Classifying the knowledge employees will need
- Considering the changing nature of relevant issues – such as:
 - SLEPT and PESTEL factors
 - Growth or contraction of the marketplace and market share
 - Emergence or disappearance of competitors in the marketplace

- Influence of businesses which are re-branding and/or re-positioning themselves in the marketplace.

Identifying licensing requirements

Identifying licensing requirements is a very broad category of research.

It requires investigation of:

- Compulsory licences, permits and/or qualifications/credentials that employees must hold in order to be compliant with legislation
- Requirements imposed by Codes of Practice and Schemes to which the organisation subscribes
- Currency of certification of workers to allow them to operate equipment/technology (such as computers, databases and booking systems) which are necessary for the business to function effectively
- Promises made by the operator – in terms of:
 - Claims made in advertisements and promotional materials about the qualifications held by staff
 - Contracts into which the organisation has entered – with providers, carriers, joint-venture partners.



Reviewing job-related documentation

Reviewing job-related documentation may entail:

- Observing work undertaken in the workplace and updating job descriptions and specifications to reflect what is actually taking place – to ensure they are relevant to current need
- Producing job descriptions and specifications for positions where none exist and there appears to be a need for workplace training
- Reading and becoming conversant with all the requirements as they apply to the positions for which training is required
- Reviewing staff performance appraisal reports produced by management/supervisors
- Reading 'Requests for Training' received from management and employees
- Reading position descriptions and other similar internal documents
- Reviewing the outcomes of previous organisational work-related analyses and which have been previously undertaken – these may include:
 - TNAs
 - Skills audit reports
- Analysing the content of current any training being provided to workers – whether delivered by the organisation or by a third party provider in order to determine its applicability/relevance.

Websites

It is useful to read the following:

<http://www.hr-guide.com/data/G510.htm> - Needs analysis: how to determine training needs

<http://workforceplanningtools.com.au/tools/training-needs-analysis/> - Training Needs Analysis

<http://www.businessballs.com/jobdescription.htm> - Job descriptions

http://humanresources.about.com/od/glossary/g/job_specification.htm - Job specification

<http://www.managementstudyguide.com/job-description-specification.htm> - Job description and job specification.

Meeting with others

Meeting with others as part of the research process may involve:

- Talking to trainers and assessors who work within workplace training systems at other organisations
- Speaking with management at businesses who operate their own workplace training systems
- Consulting with past students/learners – who have trained:
 - Within the organisation
 - With/at other providers
- Researching prospective learners who are expected to use the workplace training system – to:
 - Identify their needs, wants and preferences
 - Gain an insight into other/previous work-related training they have undertaken.



1.3 Identify the legal and other requirements that apply to the establishment and operation of the workplace training system

Introduction

At all times it is vital to ensure all externally imposed obligations are complied with when designing and establishing a workplace training system.

This section identifies how these requirements might be identified and presents a list of indicative legal and other requirements.

Identifying requirements

The primary methods to apply when seeking to identify the legal and other requirements which apply to the establishment and operation of the workplace training system include:

- Talk to people who operate their own workplace training system – to learn from their experience and obtain tips and advice from them
 - People to visit and talk to should include:
 - Management of those organisations including their Training manager
 - Trainers and assessors working on the system
 - Learners who are in the system and learners who have completed training in the system
- Meet with government officials who represent the vocational training sector of the country – in order to:
 - Establish a relationship/rapport with them to facilitate the exchange of information
 - Obtain copies of relevant legislation, guides, advices, information sheets, application forms and other important/necessary documentation
 - Learn about incentives which may be available to support the establishment of the system and/or provide ongoing funding to help with operating the system
- Read all the materials provided by the government officials who represent the vocational training sector of the country – in order to:
 - Determine mandatory requirements for *establishing and registering* as a recognised provider
 - Identify ongoing obligations in relation to continued operation as a recognised training provider
 - Make a list of questions arising from reading the documents – so these can be followed up as appropriate with (for example) government representatives, internal management of the organisation, legal advisors, accountants, the HR department of the business.



Examples of requirements

Training systems operating as an unrecognised training provider

It is important to understand if an organisation decides to operate its workplace training system as an **unrecognised** training provider there will be no legal requirements that have to be complied with.



An unrecognised system means:

- The organisation cannot indicate it is a recognised provider and cannot use the names or logos used by the national training system
- The organisation can deliver any type of training it wants to as it deems fit for its own purposes with no reference to external requirements in relation to content, assessment, standards or criteria
- The training delivered will not be recognised in terms of national trade/vocational certifications within the accredited qualifications framework
- There is no obligation for training to be assessed – although most training *is* assessed for internal purposes
- The system, trainers, assessors, records, resources and practices of the system are not subject to inspections and audits by external government officials
- The organisation may issue its own internal certificate to learners who complete course – but this certificate is, of course, not recognised by the national accredited system although certificate holders may be entitled to RPL as a result of the work they have done.

Training systems operating a recognised training provider

Where the organisation decides to establish a workplace training system which will operate as a recognised training provider:

- This means they will be authorised to deliver and assess accredited courses/qualifications:
 - Established/available under the qualifications framework that exists in the country
 - In the competency disciplines/industry sectors they have been approved to deliver in (according to their Scope of Registration)

The Scope of Registration is the list of qualifications a recognised training has been approved by the government to deliver – the organisation may **only** deliver qualifications which are on their Scope of Registration
- There will be a range of compliance obligations imposed by the relevant government body and the legislation which governs implementation of vocational training
- These requirements may be *similar* between countries but individual differences are to be expected.

It is critical to understand these requirements are mandatory – they are not optional, and they are not offered as ‘suggestions’.

If requirements are not complied with/adhered to:

- Initial registration may be disallowed for new applicants
- Current registered providers may have their registration terminated.

They must be complied with in order to:

- Establish and maintain a high-level basic standard across all providers
- Ensure quality and consistency in the provision of accredited training
- Facilitate the management and control of vocational training and assessment, record keeping and issuing of certification
- Give students and industry confidence in the quality, content and delivery of accredited vocational training and assessment.



Legal and other requirements may include and/or relate to:

- Initial establishment requirements for the system – in terms of, for example:
 - Application forms to be used for the application
 - Information and documentation to be provided to authorities about the applicant organisation – such as details of financial position, insurance, business registration and similar
 - Compulsory requirement to attend nominated information session/s – which may be conducted to:
 - Advise on and assist with application procedures
 - Provide targeted information on certain mandatory topics – such as finance, training delivery, reporting, audits
 - Details of trainers and assessors to be used with reference to their qualifications and/or industry experience
 - Details of resources provided/available to support/enable training delivery and assessments
 - A business case for the proposition demonstrating the need for and viability of the initiative
 - Proof of protocols to support:
 - Governance of the system
 - Implementation of quality training and assessment
 - Effective financial management of the training system
 - Recognition of certification/qualifications issued by other recognised training providers under the recognised system
 - Equal opportunity principles relating to access and equity issues

- Issuing of certificates and record keeping for same
 - Sample/model learning and assessment strategies
 - Model policies for designated topics – which might address:
 - Complaints handling
 - Fees and charges
 - Refunds
- Evidence of compliance with all legislated obligations relating to the operation of a business – in terms, for example, taxation, health and safety, social justice, industrial relations, public liability insurance
- Fee/s to be paid on application
- Compliance obligations for ongoing licensing/registration to continue operation of the system – which may address:
 - Reporting requirements
 - Auditing and inspection of the established system
 - Maintenance of required records
 - Updating of qualifications for trainers and assessors as required
 - Maintaining relevance of resources used/available
 - Ongoing consultation with industry
 - Payment of ongoing fees.



Other possible obligations

It is always possible a workplace training system may be required to also comply with other obligations – for example there may be a need to:

- Comply with training requirements contained in relevant employment contracts
- Meet standards or specified requirements set by professional industry bodies in relation to:
 - The initial training of employees
 - The maintenance of skill and knowledge levels and standards
- Deliver training and assessment services to other businesses/personnel – to meet obligations imposed by contracts or other non-binding 'working agreements' which have been negotiated with other organisations
- Observe the standards prescribed by internal training-related policies which oblige the organisation to deliver certain services and/or achieve nominated outcomes over-and-above those which may be legislated or provided for under any other form of obligation.

1.4 Document and verify identified operational features and constraints of the workplace training system

Introduction

Standard procedure when working on the design of a workplace training system is to document and verify all the operational features and constraints identified for the system.

This section discusses how issues may be verified and addresses documenting the agreed features and constraints.



Verifying the issues

Once operational features and constraints likely to impact the design and operation of a workplace training system have been identified, the issues need to be verified before the proposal goes any further.

It is important to bear in mind this process necessitates the spending of a large amount of time and it is vital this step is not forgotten in the rush to proceed/get the system in place.

Aim of the process

This process seeks to:

- Confirm all relevant features and constraints have been identified – and nothing vital or obvious has been forgotten or over-looked
- Check each identified issue has been assessed – and its potential impact or influence has been correctly analysed
- Validate data, research, findings and conclusions reached – as a result of the research process
- Authenticate the detail of any information which remains dubious, unclear or ambiguous – so there is clarity of understanding about all pertinent aspects of the proposal/situation
- Gain agreement from stakeholders about information obtained – so the analysis of the features and constraints can be approved/ratified by those who know the proposal and have a stake in its success/operation.

Practical aspects of the process

The process of verifying the issues may involve:

- Meeting with the research team – to:
 - Review information, findings and data
 - Discuss the research data/information obtained
 - Make sense/meaning of the information available

- Consulting with key stakeholders – as identified in section 1.1 who may include:
 - Business owners
 - The Board of Management within the organisation
 - Industry, professional and trade associations and bodies
 - Qualified trainers and assessors
 - Team leaders, supervisors and managers
 - Training participants and employees – past and present
 - Technical experts
 - Union representatives
 - Consultative committees within the business
 - Relevant industry training providers and associated training agencies
- Re-calculating figures – which will relate to:
 - Costs
 - Budgets
 - ROI
 - Investment of time
 - Resource acquisition and development
- Running a last cost-benefit analysis of the intended proposal – to:
 - Demonstrate the modelling for the final proposal
 - Finalise due diligence requirements
- Ensuring completeness of facts and information – it is important:
 - All the relevant information has been sourced
 - Accuracy of all data and information is checked and confirmed
 - Sufficient detail has been obtained and declared valid/correct and sufficient
 - Information available supports the decision to establish the workplace training system being proposed
 - Available facts and information will withstand objective analysis of the decision to proceed as planned/proposed
- Comparing proposed course of action with actions taken by other similar business – to:
 - Prove the worth and value of the proposal
 - Corroborate the planned decision
- Getting final approval from key stakeholders and management/business owners – in terms of them 'signing off' they agree with the identified features and constraints which have been documented.



Documenting the issues

Reasons to document

It is necessary and important to document all the agreed features and constraints applying to the design of a proposed workplace training system so:

- There is a firm and definite reference point for future use – as opposed to relying on personal memories and recollections of events, promises, data and so on
- There is a record (or proof) of work/research that has been undertaken – to justify the time and expense spent on this phase of the project
- Due diligence can be demonstrated – as an integral part of the design and development stage
- The information can be quickly and efficiently shared – between those who need to view the material
- Rationales behind decisions made can be understood at a later time – if the need to re-visit/analyse previous reasons for arriving at certain conclusions
- Copies of documents, reports, statistics, forms and other paperwork captured as part of the research process can be placed on record/filed for future use – such as in activities including:
 - Making applications for registration
 - Preparing business cases, proposals and plans
 - Establishing management and administration structures for the initiative
 - Developing required operational protocols.



Options

The standard options for documenting identified features and constraints attaching to the proposal to design and establish a workplace training system are:

- Producing and/or filing documents in hard copy form
- Creating or filing soft copies of all documents
- A combination of the two above options.

Standard organisational filing protocols should apply to facilitate use of the files and retrieval of information – these will relate to aspects such as:

- Maintaining confidentiality and privacy of information, data and intentions/plans
- Document control – to monitor access to/distribution and release of documents/files
- Version control – to ensure those using the data can identify previous versions and the current version of each category of document.

1.5 Identify the resources available to support the identified workplace training system requirements

Introduction

The research phase when designing a workplace training system begins a set of relationships with key stakeholders.

This section repeats information about stakeholders presented in section 1.1 and presents a series of activities which have proven effective in establishing and maintaining required relationships with them.



Stakeholders

Stakeholders are people/organisations with a stake/interest in a decision or project.

Sometimes:

- Stakeholders are referred to as 'key stakeholders' – in which case there is no difference between the two
- Key stakeholders are more important or influential to the decision or project – and may therefore carry more weight or influence when decisions are made.

Stakeholders in the design and establishment of a workplace training system will vary depending on:

- Company size and structure
- Whether or not the organisation wants to be a recognised training provider or not
- Partnership arrangements and working agreements which exist between the organisation and other businesses.

In overview key stakeholders may include:

- Business owners
- The Board of Management within the organisation
- Industry, professional and trade associations and bodies
- Qualified trainers and assessors
- Team leaders, supervisors and managers
- Training participants and employees – past and present
- Technical experts
- Union representatives
- Consultative committees within the business
- Relevant industry training providers and associated training agencies.

Activities in establishing and maintaining relationships

A selection of the following techniques should be used to establish and maintain relationships with stakeholders:

- Demonstrate a positive attitude and willingness towards stakeholders – to:
 - Meet with them
 - Learn from them
 - Communicate with them
- Request meetings – using initial contact methods such as:
 - A telephone call
 - An email
- Follow up requests for meetings with face-to-face contact – which may occur:
 - At their workplace/designated location
 - At the workplace where the training system is to be established
 - At a neutral common meeting place
- Get to know each person/organisation – in terms of their:
 - Contact details
 - Experience and expertise
 - Needs and wants from the relationship
- Plan for the contacts – by, as appropriate:
 - Developing a contact schedule with attention to mutually acceptable dates and times/durations
 - Notifying others sufficiently well in advance of the meetings and advising them of the topics which will be raised
 - Preparing the meeting location/room
 - Generating questions requiring input/contributions from those who will be at meetings
- Work in an ethical manner – for example:
 - Honour all promises made
 - Be truthful at all times
 - Never ask them to compromise their position or betray confidences
 - Never betray confidences
 - Respect the other parties
 - Be mindful of their needs and sensitivities



- Communicate effectively when liaising/meeting with others – for example:
 - Listen attentively and actively
 - Take notes when meeting/talking with them
 - Display positive and open non-verbal communication signals
 - Read, interpret and respond appropriately to their body language
 - Make and distribute minutes of meetings
 - Use electronic communication to facilitate contact and communication
- Assist them in whatever way the organisation is able – as well as seeking to simply benefit from the relationship

There must be a two way flow of information – there must be ‘give’ as well as ‘take’ in the relationship; there must be ‘mutual benefit’
- Ask stakeholders to participate in a range of meetings and activities designed to produce information and advice relevant to the design and development of the training system – such as:
 - Conducting structured interviews
 - Holding regular and scheduled team meetings
 - Using focus groups
 - Designing and applying questionnaires
 - Capitalising on informal and social interactions – including networking opportunities
 - Conducting workshops
- Thank them:
 - For attending meetings, taking calls and responding to emails/questions
 - For their contributions
 - For their effort
- Keep in contact – which means:
 - Being proactive in staying in contact with them
 - Scheduling regular contact sessions
 - Not simply contacting them only when something is needed.



1.6 Identify the resources available to support the identified workplace training system requirements

Introduction

Another important consideration when researching the features of a workplace training system to be established is the need to identify the resources available to support the initiative.

This section identifies the three classifications of resources required and examines how available resources might be determined.

Contents of this section are further addressed in sections 2.1, 2.2, 2.3 and 2.4.



Resource classifications

Resources required supporting the design and implementation of a workplace training system fall into three categories:

- Human resources
- Physical resources
- Financial resources.

Human resources

Human resources in this regard refer to staff required to operate the system.

These may include:

- Trainers
- Assessors
- Guest speakers
- External professionals/consultants who may be required to assist with training provision or assessment tasks
- Course developers
- Resource writers
- Administration support – to:
 - Maintain required records
 - Undertake traditional office-related functions.

Physical resources

Physical resources in this regard refer to the items required to allow training and assessment to occur.

Some items may be dedicated solely to training and some may be shared between training and the other operations of the business.

Physical resources may include:

- Training delivery equipment – such as a training room with associated training equipment which might include:
 - Desks/tables and chairs
 - Computers (personal computers and/or laptops) with software appropriate to the needs of the training
 - Data projectors
 - Laser pointers
 - Overhead projector
 - Screens (for projection of images)
 - White boards (standard or electric)
 - Printers
 - Photocopier
 - TV monitor
 - DVD player/video machine
 - Easels for flip charts
- Training and assessment resources – which are the materials used to help with delivery of training and conduct of assessments:
 - Notes and handouts
 - Texts, manuals and reference books
 - Exercise books
 - Rolls/attendance registers
 - Consumables – such as paper, general stationery, chalk, whiteboard markers, disks
 - Assessment items – tests, checklist, question sheets, exercise sheets, case studies, work projects.



Financial resources

Financial resources in this regard refer to the funding available to be spent on training and assessment activities.

Financial resources may be:

- Internally based – in the form of:
 - Budgets for training and assessment
 - Cash from administration
 - Fees paid by students/learners
 - In the form of 'product' (or items) as opposed to the money needed to buy those things

- Externally based – in the form of:
 - Co-contributions from partners
 - Donations from providers, suppliers, carriers or other industry bodies
 - Grants
 - Subsidies.



Determining availability

Determining availability of the resources available for the establishment and ongoing implementation of a workplace training system may be identified by:

- Talking with management – to identify:
 - What they are prepared to spend/authorise
 - When it will be available
 - How it can be accessed
- Speaking with the Finance Department/Head office – to identify:
 - What has been allocated/budgeted for the purposes of training and assessment
 - Requirements for spending same – such as need for quotations for amounts over a certain value, requirement to purchase from preferred suppliers, limits on individual spending ceilings/limits
- Contacting industry bodies and organisations which represent the industry – to identify if they have:
 - Grants or subsidies available
 - Resources which can be borrowed or used
- Discussing resourcing of training with government agencies – to determine if they have:
 - Grants
 - Subsidies
 - Taxation concessions
 - Special schemes to support vocational and/or workplace training
- Asking third parties for assistance – in relation to possibilities such as:
 - Donations of product and/or equipment
 - Discounts for training-related purchases
 - Loans of equipment and items
 - Providing guest speakers and other training-specific expertise.

Websites

It is worthwhile looking at the following:

<http://www.serviceskills.com.au/rtos/support-materials> - Support materials

<https://shop.tafesa.edu.au/LOR/Home.aspx> - TAFEshop training resources

<http://www.tourismtraining.com.au/contact/contact.html> - Tourism Training Australia

<http://www.tesaaustralia.com/article.aspx?storyCode=6278198> – Travel, tourism and leisure teaching resources

<http://www.tourism.australia.com/contact-us/student-resources.aspx> - Student resources: Tourism Australia.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project forms the basis for following Work Projects

To fulfil the requirements of the Work Projects for this Unit you are required to identify a workplace to be approved by your Trainer/Assessor and design and establish a workplace training system for that organisation.

1.1 To fulfil the requirements of this Work Project you are required to determine the features for the system providing evidence you have:

- Identified key operational features and constraints required of the workplace training system
- Researched enterprise requirements in relation to the workplace training system
- Identified the legal and other requirements that apply to the establishment and operation of the workplace training system
- Documented and verified identified operational features and constraints of the workplace training system
- Established and maintained relationships with key stakeholders
- Identified the resources available to support the identified workplace training system requirements.

Summary

Determine the features of a workplace training system

When determining the features of a workplace training system:

- Identify key operational features of the workplace
- Determine operational constraints the system must operate within
- Clarify what the organisation wants to achieve by having their own training system
- Analyse business plans and objectives
- Involve key stakeholders
- Conduct primary and secondary research activities to obtain quantitative and qualitative data
- Ensure identification of all legislated obligations
- Integrate system requirements with organisational aims
- Use a team approach
- Identify the approach to be taken in relation to training and assessment
- Work out if the system is to be recognised or non-recognised by local Training Authority
- Specify operational requirements for the system
- Analyse potential learners and candidates by need and number
- Document and share operational features of the system
- Establish, cultivate and maintain positive relationships with stakeholders
- Identify resources required to support/enable the system.

Element 2:

Align workplace training needs with required resources

2.1 Match human resources to identified workplace training needs

Introduction

Human resources need to be allocated to training and assessment needs to enable required outcomes/targets to be achieved.

This section gives an over-arching perspective on resource allocation to workplace training and assessments and discusses considerations in regard to human resources.

Overall perspective on resource allocation

It needs to be understood:

- The allocation of one resource type (human, physical or financial) can rarely be considered in isolation – there is frequently/usually a co-dependence between all three classifications and a blurring of the distinction between one classification of resources and another
- Arguably ‘financial’ resources are the most important consideration – as often, the acquisition or provision of all other resources other resources depends entirely or significantly on funding
- Planning of the training and assessment must precede actual allocation – this means appropriate allocation of resources will depend on:
 - Knowledge of numbers to be trained and/or assessed
 - Understanding about pre-entry status (knowledge levels, abilities, experience of learners and their results with previous interactions with training/assessment)
 - Identification of content and qualifications to be delivered
 - Knowledge of special needs of learners and those to be assessed
 - Delivery schedule for training and assessment
 - Clarity about exactly what the system is expected to achieve
- There is rarely sufficient funding to enable all the preferred options for resource allocation to be implemented – there is nearly always a limit to what is available/can be spent so there is often a need to:
 - Do the best possible with what is available
 - Change plans/initial intentions to accommodate emerging constraints



- Do more with less
- Allocation must always be time-dependent – that is, they need to always relate to, as appropriate, a specific period such as:
 - A year, quarter or month
 - Time required to complete a course/qualification
 - A nominated training session or series of sessions
 - A nominated time frame specified by providers of grants, subsidies, donations and similar.



Staffing considerations

All of the following must be taken into account when making decisions to match human resources to identified workplace training needs:

- Specifying the experience and expertise required by those who will be trainers and assessors – so training delivery will meet identified workplace need and so assessments will ensure candidates are competent as required for the workplace
- Working out the training and/or assessment qualifications required by those who will be doing the training and assessing – note:
 - If the organisation opts to be a recognised provider then there will be mandatory requirements in this regard imposed by the authorities
 - If the training system is non-recognised there is no limit apart from common sense, physical capacity and the need for training to be delivered effectively
- Determining the ratio of learners to trainers and candidates for assessment to assessors – there may be a prescribed ratio (say, 1:15 for trainers and 1:1 for practical assessments) but the organisation may (if permissible) elect to use a different figure
- Identifying the length of training sessions – and integrating these with total time required to complete training delivery and assessment/s as this will be a major influence on number of trainers required (or on alternatives which might be necessary – such as extending target dates for completion of courses)
- Determining the amount of time (number of hours per week) trainers can spend actually delivering training – and what hours are allocated for preparation and/or assessing
- Engaging suitable and sufficient trainers and assessors – which may involve:
 - Recruiting/promoting individuals from within the organisation to these positions
 - Deciding if the organisation wants to:
 - Hire full-time or part-time trainers and assessors
 - Use full-time employees from other departments and allocate them a time fraction (X hours per week) for training and assessment activities and responsibilities
 - Engage professionals from another system/institution
 - Advertising externally, interviewing and selecting successful applicants

- Conducting inductions and orientation to the position and/or organisation
- Allowing sufficient lead time – for trainers and assessors to:
 - Learn about the organisation and the system
 - Gain necessary qualifications, where applicable
 - Prepare training and assessment materials to support/enable proposed training and assessment schedule
 - Set-up the training rooms and acquire the necessary resources
 - Promote the training system and recruit learners
- Ensuring appropriate administration support – in order to, for example:
 - Enrol/register learners
 - Maintain required records
 - Monitor budgets
 - Prepare required reports
 - Follow-up on 'issues arising' with learners, training and/or assessment activities.



2.2 Match physical resources to identified workplace training needs

Introduction

The workplace training system must be provided with physical resources to allow it to provide planned delivery and assessment activities.

This section discusses considerations in this regard.

Physical resource considerations

Note: The heading 'Overall perspective on resource allocation' presented in the previous section must be read in conjunction with the notes below.

Physical resources needed to support a workplace training system can be classified as:

- Training materials – notes, texts, handouts, slides, overhead projection sheets, text books, manuals
- Consumables – paper, chalk, printer/toner cartridges, disks, whiteboard markers, overhead projector pens
- Equipment necessary for training delivery – tables, chairs, desks, data projector, computers, photocopier, printer

All of the following must be taken into account when making decisions to match physical resources to identified workplace training needs:

- These resources must be sufficient in number – to enable the planned delivery schedule to take place:
 - Effectively and efficiently
 - When scheduled
- Resources used must reflect actual workplace practice – meaning (for example):
 - Equipment used in the workplace must be the same learners use in their training
 - Systems and technology/software used in training must be what is used in the office
- All items must be safe to use – which means:
 - A need to inspect and check them prior to use
 - On-going need to maintain/service equipment
- Session plans for each session (training and assessment) should contain:
 - Details of content/what is to be achieved
 - List of the type physical resources required to achieve the planned objective/s
 - Quantities required for every identified resource



- If special needs learners are being trained or assessed there must be resources to meet their individual needs – in order to genuinely accommodate equity and access principles
- It may be possible to acquire physical resources for the purposes of training and/or assessment in other ways other than purchasing them outright – for example it may be possible to:
 - Visit another workplace to use what they have
 - Borrow items from other businesses
 - Joint purchase expensive items with several other training providers
 - Ask for donations
 - Re-schedule training/assessment so workplace equipment/items can be used when the business is closed.



2.3 Match financial resources to identified workplace training needs

Introduction

There is an on-going need to ensure funds are made available to underpin planned training and assessment needs.

This section discusses considerations in this regard.

Financial resource considerations

Note: The heading 'Overall perspective on resource allocation' presented in the section 2.1 must be read in conjunction with the notes below.

All of the following must be taken into account when making decisions to match financial resources to identified workplace training needs:

- Funds to pay wages for trainers and assessors – who are employed as dedicated trainers and assessors
- Money to back-fill staff who are attending training – to:
 - Enable normal service levels to be maintained
 - Avoid placing extra/undue pressure on staff who do not attend training
- Payments for staff who are attending training out-of-hours – in accordance with:
 - Relevant employment instruments
 - Legislated requirements
 - Agreed/promised arrangements
- Money to pay for travel and accommodation, where applicable – such as:
 - For guest speakers who visit the workplace and provide specialist training and/or assessment services
 - For trainers and assessors to attend vocational seminars and other industry-focussed activities
 - For learners to attend remote sites for the purposes of excursions, external training and/or off-site assessments
- Payment in relation to training materials and equipment – which may involve:
 - Research and development of:
 - Training notes/handouts
 - Assessment items – tests, written exercises, verbal questions, practical demonstration of skill
 - Purchase or other acquisition of resources
 - Up-dating materials to maintain currency and address identified shortcomings/deficiencies



- Money to support/enable training delivery and assessment – which can relate to:
 - Payment for consumables
 - Payment for incidentals
 - Money to implement requirements which are imposed by external audits and orders
 - Funds for replacement items where they are damaged through use in training and assessment
 - Need for additional items on the basis of increased demand on the workplace training and assessment system
 - Changes to demands on the system occurring as a result of alterations to legislation, codes to which the organisation subscribes and/or various training-related compliance requirements (for example, Quality Management, moderation) which apply
- Money to supplement additional remuneration to employees – in accordance with promises made when nominated competencies have been achieved.



2.4 Identify external funding sources for the workplace training system

Introduction

Most workplaces strive to identify and capitalise on external funding to assist with the establishment and operation of their workplace training systems.

This section lists and explores the standard external sources of funding commonly available to businesses to help them supplement their own financial contributions to the initiative.

External sources

External funding sources may include:

- Other departments within the organisation
- Head office
- Sub-agencies
- Suppliers, providers, carriers or destination operators
- Government agencies
- Occasional funding made available through industry bodies
- Learners.



Other departments within the same organisation

The training system within the organisation may be funded (entirely or partially) from contributions made by different department within the business which will benefit from the presence of the workplace training.

Their contributions may be:

- A set amount per department – regardless of staff from the department who will be trained, and regardless of the hours of training/costs associated directly to their training/assessment
- A percentage based figure
- Directly related to the costs of training and assessment for the staff from the department.

Head office

Where a business operates under a structure where they are under the control of a Head Office it is standard practice:

- To be offered some financial assistance to establish and maintain a workplace training system – the amount can vary significantly but will usually be related to:
 - Actual and perceived benefits
 - Cost savings resulting from the initiative
 - Size of the business and proposed number of staff to be trained/training hours to be delivered
 - Previous allocations to other offices/businesses in the organisation

- To formally *request* funding as opposed to expecting it will be provided – identifying:
 - When funds are needed – SOP is to provide as much advance notice as possible
 - Need for same and how it will be used
 - Amount required
 - Consequences if funding is not made available
 - Cost of obtaining funds from an alternate source
- Funds will be tagged – meaning they:
 - Can only be spent on nominated items
 - Must be accounted for.

Sub-agencies

If the organisation works in a business environment where they operate sub-agencies it may be acceptable to:

- Require each sub-agency to use the workplace training system being established
- Charge a fee for every worker from the sub-agency who participates in training – often based on a cost recovery orientation, or on the capacity of the sub-agency to pay
- Levy a set training charge/amount across all sub-agencies regardless of the use they will make of the workplace training system.

Suppliers, providers, carriers or destination operators

It is possible suppliers, providers, carriers or destination operators may be prepared to make a contribution to assist with operating a workplace training system.

This is always an option to be tried but one which may not produce much in the way of tangible results.

Funding may be in the form of:

- Cash grants/donations
- Discounts for products bought from them
- Fees for staff they send to the training.

This approach tends to most effective if the other party:

- Is seeking to create or maintain positive relations with the organisation
- Stands to benefit in some way from the outcomes produced as a result of the workplace training to be provided
- Has staff of its own they want to send to the training being proposed.



Government agencies

Government agencies are a common source of external funding.

The type and amount of funding available alters over time often reflecting:

- Changes in government
- Amendments to government policies
- Identified industry need and/or economic opportunity.

Typical options in relation to government funding are:

- One-off grants to enable establish workplace training and assessment systems – to save governments the cost of building their own vocational training outlets
- One-off grants support targeted training – which is designed to address identified shortages in the labour market
- On-going subsidies to encourage the uptake of apprenticeships and traineeships – which function by paying the employer money intended to off-set the cost of training and employing an unskilled worker.



Government funding will commonly require:

- Formal application using nominated forms to provide mandatory information and proof of eligibility
- Rationale/justification for the funding
- Co-contribution by the organisation towards the ultimate use of the funding – this co-contribution may be stipulated amount or percentage of the total value of the project
- Spending of funds on targeted items – there is rarely opportunity to spend funds on ‘anything’ as the money is usually tagged for specific purposes
- Proof of purchase and adherence to designated compliance, reporting and accountability criteria.

Occasional funding made available through industry bodies

From time-to-time peak industry bodies may announce they have cash available to assist industry operators with workplace training.

This is not a common funding source.

Most opportunities in relation to this option are brief (they are ‘open’ only for a relatively short time), and the amounts involved are relatively small.

Applications for and obligations attaching to these funds are similar to government funding:

- Formal applications have to be made
- Rationale/justification for the funding
- Co-contribution by the organisation
- Spending of funds on targeted items
- Proof of purchase and adherence to designated compliance, reporting and accountability criteria.

Learners

In some limited circumstances organisations may be legitimately able to charge fees to learners for attending training and assessment sessions.

This may be the case where:

- People from outside the organisation want to engage with study
- Staff from inside the organisation want to participate in training which is not a pre-requisite for their job – perhaps they are doing it to gain employment elsewhere.



2.5 Prepare a budget for the workplace training system

Introduction

Workplace training systems traditionally require a set of budgets to support their establishment and operation.

This section presents a general overview of practices inherent in preparing budgets information and lists generic considerations related to expenditure budgets.



Preparing budgets

Issues to address when considering budgets for a workplace training systems will depend on the accounting system being used by the organisation as well as related accounting issues.

The following is an indicative list of topics which need to be taken into account when initially preparing budgets for the proposal:

- Access overall budgets and plans for the business – so the budgets for the training system can be put into a proper context against all other organisational budgets/financial obligations and goals
- Name likely or known income sources which have been identified as part of the research process – which will require development of revenue budgets
- Determine classification of expenditure budgets – to address expected costs for the initiative: see ‘General considerations relating to expenditure budgets’ below
- Use a team to develop draft budgets – comprising members of the research team, management and the Financial/Accounting department
- Obtain quotations and calculate costings for initial acquisition of plant, equipment, technology and physical resources
- Generate budget outcomes and figures which are achievable, accurate and comprehensive
- Integrate workplace training budgets into the suite of budgets already in existence within the business
- Prepare a budget manual – to explain the operations of the budgets
- Identify relevant budget lines and budget codes
- Develop procedures and systems to meet relevant statutory and internal control requirements
- Determine reporting protocols – for capturing and disseminating budget information and related reports
- Develop monitoring protocols and reviewing protocols – for assessing actual performance of budgets against estimated performance
- Explain and describe the operation of budgets to those with responsibility for them/for using them.

General considerations relating to expenditure budgets

The orientation to expenditure budgets for development of a workplace training system must adopt three specific orientations.

There must be consideration of:

- Development costs – in terms of costs involved in:
 - Establishing training facilities and physical resources
 - Creating the training infrastructure within the organisation
 - Training and preparing personnel to operate as trainers and assessors
 - Obtaining training resources and materials
- Implementation costs – in relation to:
 - Staffing costs
 - Consumables
 - Advertising and promoting the initiative
 - Reward and recognitions attached to engagement with/completion of training
 - Power
 - Overheads
- Maintenance costs – such as:
 - Costs associated with updating training content – to:
 - Maintain its relevance and keep it current
 - Address identified problems and/or feedback received from learners and/or trainers and assessors
 - Review and evaluate training delivery and assessment practices
 - Modifying training content and/or delivery in accordance with emerging need
 - Provision of refresher training to workplace employees as identified
 - Up-dating of certifications for trainers and assessors
 - Repairs, maintenance and service to equipment.



2.6 Obtain management commitment to the workplace training system

Introduction

Effective workplace training will only ever occur if management in the organisation is committed to the concept.

This section presents and discusses a range of issues associated with obtaining necessary management commitment to a proposal to establish and operate a workplace training system.



Obtaining management commitment

Considerations and activities inherent in obtaining management commitment to implementation and operation of a workplace training system include:

- Demonstrating to them the benefits which will flow from establishing and operating the system – such as:
 - Providing examples of modelling, case studies and/or cost-benefit analyses
 - Improved skill levels of staff and ability to cross-skill/multi-skill employees
 - Reduced accidents/workplace injuries and/or mistakes
 - Potential/ability to engage with new markets, products or services
 - Cost savings
 - Enhanced reputation of the organisation
- Highlighting disadvantages for the business of **not** proceeding with the initiative – which may relate to:
 - Losing market share and/or position
 - Not having sufficient trained staff or being able to source/hire staff with required abilities and/or knowledge
 - Expenses associated with breaching compliance issues and/or making operational mistakes which would be obviated through training
 - Lost opportunities and sales as a result of lack of knowledge or insufficient skill levels
- Considering a reward and recognition scheme applying to workers who participate in workplace training – which may encompass:
 - Awarding of internal certificates for successful completion of training
 - Increased remuneration based on skill levels/competencies
 - One-off bonuses for successful completion – cash, product, services
 - Incentives to commence training
 - Reimbursement on successful completion of training of training-expenses incurred by employees
 - Paid time off for study/to attend training

- Making a formal presentation to the management team – which will need to include:
 - Meeting with them to make a verbal presentation – often also using a PowerPoint presentation
 - Supplementing the verbal presentation with handout materials which provide evidence of and support for the points being made
 - Including a Q&A session
 - Seeking approval for the initiative as presented
- Gaining agreement from management they will support the proposal in practical ways within the organisation – by, for example:
 - Preparedness to speak in support of training within the organisation at various staff meetings
 - Encouraging staff participation with workplace training
 - Willingness to promote staff from within the based on competency gained via workplace training – as opposed to looking outside the organisation for new staff/people to promote
- Receiving advice from management relating to the request for approval – which may be verbal or in writing but will need to include:
 - Approval of and commitment to the initiative
 - Confirmation of their financial commitment to the initiative – stating the resources which will be provided/authorised
 - Statement advising of their commitment to the proposal
 - Directions to middle-level managers/supervisors to support the initiative and take necessary action to facilitate its implementation.



2.7 Identify sources of provision for workplace training materials and delivery

Introduction

To assist with operating and maintaining a viable workplace training system there is a constant need to identify cost-effective sources of provision for training materials and other items required to support and sustain workplace training delivery.

This section identifies possible sources of materials and other resources which can be used for training delivery and associated activities.



Possible sources

Sources of provision may include:

- Existing informal training unit within the organisation or workplace – it is possible:
 - The organisation operated an effective informal training branch before the decision to introduce a more formal system was made
 - This informal system nonetheless purchased, produced or otherwise acquired some extremely relevant and effective training materials which can continue to be used in the new, formal system
- Outsourcing – which may:
 - Include use of materials which have been developed by and are being used by other private and/or public registered training providers
 - Involve purchasing commercially available training products and materials – which can include:
 - Customised products available on a fee-for-service basis, produced specifically to meet the individual training requirements of specific workplaces
 - Consideration of using 'off the shelf', generic, pre-prepared materials as opposed to developing organisation-specific customised materials or those which have been produced in-house

Where materials are obtained from other sources there can be a need to:

- Review the potential relevance of materials – to ensure they are actually meeting identified need and are if not workplace-specific at least industry-specific
- Be sensitive to culture cost associated with using materials/resources not produced by the business and seeming to have to rely on outside sources for expertise in this regard

- Product suppliers – who may be prepared to:
 - Donate samples of materials they have developed and use in their business
 - Contribute examples of items they have accumulated over time
 - Lend materials for short-term periods or on long-term or permanent loan
 - Share materials they use or have access to
 - Offer materials in exchange for purchases made by the organisation
- Service providers – who may be willing to:
 - Allow their staff to assist with resource development for the workplace
 - Let their staff visit and show/demonstrate use of relevant materials
 - Contribute in ways identified for 'Product suppliers' immediately above
- Industry peak bodies – who may have:
 - A range of generic training materials available for loan or purchase
 - Materials contributed to them by other industry organisations for use/distribution as training resources
 - A library/resource centre of materials and resources
- Government agencies – who will often:
 - Be able to supply copies of legislation, regulations and mandatory Codes
 - Donate a range of handout materials, posters, charts and reports
 - Be able to identify other sources which could be followed up to determine if they have/are able to contribute required materials
- Training institutions – who may be prepared to:
 - Share physical resources
 - Grant access to electronic resources
 - Suggest avenues to pursue
 - Offer materials in exchange for access to some aspect of the workplace training or assessment being provided in the workplace
- Other workplaces – this relates to approaching similar/relevant other businesses with a view to:
 - Identifying if they have training materials they are willing to share
 - Determining if they are amenable to sharing costs for purchasing certain resources which can be jointly used
 - Negotiating a mutually-beneficial arrangement where both parties develop and then share nominated materials for training which is conducted at both workplaces.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project follows from Work Project 1.1

2.1 For the organisation/workplace identified in Work Project 1.1 align workplace training needs with required resources providing evidence you have:

- Matched human resources to identified workplace training needs
 - Matched physical resources to identified workplace training needs
 - Matched financial resources to identified workplace training needs
 - Identified external funding sources for the workplace training system
 - Prepared a budget for the workplace training system
 - Obtained management commitment to the workplace training system
 - Identified sources of provision for workplace training materials and delivery.
-

Summary

Align workplace training needs with required resources

When aligning workplace training needs with required resources:

- Match identified need with specific human, physical and financial resources
- Ensure trainers and assessors have suitable industry experience and operational competencies
- Determine and make sure trainers and assessors hold required training qualifications
- Ensure physical training resources are safe, sufficient and relevant to workplace need
- Develop/acquire suitable training resources and materials
- Generate assessment items to assess stated competencies
- Search potential for financial support/funding from external bodies
- Prepare budgets and supporting financial management systems
- Obtain commitment from management to support and promote the workplace training system.

Element 3:

Develop workplace training system documents

3.1 Develop training policies and procedures to support implementation and operation of the workplace training system

Introduction

A variety of policies and procedures will need to be developed to support the implementation of the workplace training system.

This section provides some context to policies and procedures in this regard, differentiates between 'policies' and 'procedures', looks at format and content, and presents topics which may be the focus for training-related policies.



Context

The extent to which training policies and procedures will be developed will depend on a range of factors.

It is to be expected training policies and procedures will vary to some extent between every workplace.

Factors determining the policies and procedures to be developed include:

- Whether or not the training system is a recognised training provider or a non-recognised one – in that:
 - Recognised training providers will:
 - Traditionally require more policies and procedures than non-recognised providers
 - Usually be *required* to create policies and/or procedures to address topics identified by the Training Authority – that is, it is compulsory for the workplace training system to produce certain policies and procedures as specified by the Training Authority in order (for example) to meet quality-related issues

The workplace training system may, of course, develop other policies and procedures *in addition to the mandated ones* but they must at least generate the *required ones*

- Normally have to submit compulsory draft policies and procedures to the Training Authority for their approval – as part of the process of applying for registration as an approved/recognised provider

- Non-recognised/accredited training providers:
 - Are under no obligation to develop any training/assessment-related policies and procedures
 - Can prepare policies and procedures to suit whatever they deem to be important from their point of view
- The breadth and depth of policies and procedures existing in the organisation to address non-training issues

Some organisations rely heavily on policies and procedures and some do not

Larger organisations (with multiple outlets, departments and employees) often use the more structured approach of policies and procedures than smaller businesses

Commonly:

 - Extensive policies and procedures for other *operational issues* elsewhere in the organisation will also mean extensive policies and procedures for training and assessment
 - Few policies and procedures elsewhere in the business will mean few for training/assessment
- Previous experience of the organisation with policies and procedures – for example:
 - Some businesses have protocols in place for developing, reviewing, updating and revising policies and procedures – so they are more able/willing to generate policies and procedures for any other topic
 - Some businesses despite their effort at developing and trying to use policies and procedures have found their implementation to be difficult to apply, hard to enforce and of little or no resulting benefit.



Differentiating between policies and procedures

Some organisations:

- Prepare a separate document for policies and a separate one for procedures – other organisations may combine their policy and procedures into one document
- Do not distinguish/differentiate between ‘policies’ and ‘procedures’ – they use the term ‘policies and procedures’ generically to refer to a combination of required protocols.

While there is a direct link/relationship between policies and procedures it is important to understand the distinction between the two.

Policies have the following characteristics - they:

- Represent the thinking/philosophy of the business
- Define the position of the organisation on issues which are covered by the policy
- Are developed before procedures
- State the intention and expectations of the organisation and staff in relation to the subject that is the title of the policy – they indicate:

- What the organisation wants to achieve
- How the organisation will act in given situations, if/when they arise
- Are the rules the organisation seeks to operate by
- Give consistency in the way the organisation operates
- Contain a statement explaining the reason the policy has been prepared
- Provide guidance to employees about what the organisation wants – and how they should act to help achieve that outcome
- Identify responsibilities for taking action to achieve the desired outcomes
- Prescribe timing considerations relevant to the issue
- Resolve anticipated problems in relation to the policy topic
- Identify documentation to be used or completed in relation to the topic
- Contain information on legal and regulatory requirements the organisation must meet.

Procedures have the following characteristics - they:

- Flow from policies – and it is possible there can be multiple different procedures linked to the one policy
- Enable organisational plans and policies to be implemented
- Nominate whose responsibility it is to take the actions set out in the procedures
- Explain action to take to enable the intentions of policies to be attained
- Describe action to be taken in given situations/circumstances
- May contain steps in a process in sequential order
- Give consistency to action
- Avoid confusion of roles and responsibilities
- Help prevent operational mistakes
- Name documentation that needs to be completed as part of the process
- Identify other internal documents which provide additional information or support in relation to the action being taken.



Format and content

There is no universally accepted format for policies and procedures.

Internal options

Organisations may have/generate a Style Guide which they use to govern/assist those who need to write internal policies and procedures.

These Style Guides will/may contain information on topics such as:

- Purpose of the Style Guide
- Principles of and differentiation between policies and procedures
- Styles of policies and procedures – in terms of:
 - Requirements relating to grammar, tenses, terminology, clarity, compliance with legally imposed obligations, ease of understanding, use of slashes and hyphenation, numbering, table formats, indents, headers and footers, bullet points
 - References to 'house style' – which will address:
 - Instructions to give consistency of format and appearance for all policies and procedures written – such as use of the active voice when writing
 - Lists of acceptable abbreviations and acronyms
 - Approved ways of naming the employer organisation
 - Sample policies and procedures
 - Templates to use for drafting policies and procedures
- Criteria for developing policies and procedures – addressing, for example:
 - Where and why policies will be developed
 - Determination of organisation-wide procedures compared to departmental and/or task-specific SOPs
- Rationalisation of policies and procedures – to help avoid an excessive number of policies and procedures and to streamline their approach
- Version control information
- Review and revision
- Submission for approval
- Checklist to assist those who are preparing policies and procedures – to optimise likelihood of producing compliant items.



External options

Where the organisation has elected to become a registered/accredited training provider the Training Authority may:

- Provide model policies and procedures – for the organisation to use or adapt
- Supply templates – which can be used as the basis for developing policies and procedures

In most cases, organisations will prepare their training and assessment policies and procedures using the same format as the other policies and procedures they have developed.

Standard content of policies

It is common for policies to contain the following elements/headings:

- Name/title of the policy
- Purpose of the policy – explaining why the policy has been developed
- Scope of the policy – identifying who the policy applies to/who is bound by it
- Date the policy applies – the date the policy becomes/became effective
- Legislative authority – specifying statutes which govern implementation of the policy
- Policy statement/s – statement/s indicating:
 - How this policy fits with others and with the overall operation of the business
 - Relevant commitments by management to specifics of the policy
 - Description/s of processes inherent in implementing the policy
- Responsibilities for action – giving names/titles of those with specific responsibility under the policy in areas such as, for example:
 - Compliance
 - Monitoring
 - Review
 - Record management
 - Reporting
- Consequences of non-compliance
- Definitions – in relation to policy-specific terms
- Version control information.



Procedures

Content of procedures will depend on the topic/activity for which they are being produced.

Procedures may be produced in the form of:

- Checklists
- List with bullet points/dot points
- Written steps for a task
- Flowcharts
- Process charts
- Procedural lists.



Possible topics for policies

Policies relating to workplace training systems may relate to:

- The purpose(s) of training – covering:
 - Reasons the organisation has decided to implement and operate its own workplace training system
 - Rationale for the decision to become a recognised training provider or a non-recognised training provider
 - Identification of the general learner cohort – with reference to training of internal and/or external learners
 - Names/descriptions of general training to be delivered and/or specification of qualifications to be offered
- A framework for the provision of training and assessment – detailing:
 - Details of the structure/establishment of a Training department
 - Where and when training and assessments will be conducted
 - Applicable timelines for commencement and completion of designated training
 - Requirement to adopt CBT and CBA principles
 - Specifications of experience and qualifications of trainers and assessors
 - Commitment to access, equity and social justice
- Continuous improvement – which may address issues including:
 - Commitment to a nominated QMS
 - Commitment to quality and consistency in training provision
 - Formation of a Quality Team
 - Description of the process to be followed – such as a cyclical process comprising data collection, analysis and review of feedback, action, monitoring and review
 - Imperative for staff to respond to CI issues
 - Integration of CI outcomes/findings into SOPs for the organisation

- Industrial relations issues – in reference to workplace training and assessment, in terms of:
 - Stipulating link between qualifications of employees and remuneration – such that those with more credentials receive more wages
 - Identifying of amounts to be paid to employees for achieving nominated credentials
 - Detailing workplace training and assessment opportunities provided by the organisation in certain documents – such as employment contracts, induction and orientation material
 - Handling complaints relating to issues raised about access/lack of opportunity to access workplace training and assessment
 - Indicating management intention to promote from within the organisation based on merit
 - Ensuring staff are paid to attend training and/or reimbursed for legitimate and verifiable expenses
- Eligibility for training – which may:
 - Identify *when* new employees may access workplace training – they may, for example, have to complete their Probationary Period before they can access other than mandatory job-specific training relevant to the position for which they were hired
 - Make a statement indicating the priority for training if limited opportunities exist – for example, there may be a priority for full-time employees over part-time, or a preference for experienced employees over less experienced ones
 - State there will be no discrimination regarding eligibility based on factors such as age, gender, race, religion
 - Specify cohorts of people who may be ineligible for training and assessment
- Criteria for determining competency – in terms of:
 - Defining competency
 - Indicating the criteria and standards to be considered whenever ‘competency’ is being determined – or identifying action to take to decide the criteria and standards to use
 - Setting benchmarks for competency
 - Specifying limits (or no limits) on candidate attempts at achieving competency
- Transparency in all matters relating to training and assessment – which commonly apply to:
 - Right of system stakeholders to contribute and comment on the operation and outcomes of the system
 - Access by learners and candidates to records of their own training and assessment
 - Openness and honesty regarding analysis of employees to determine requirement for training
 - Sufficient advance notification of training to be provided and assessments to be conducted



- Operational processes – especially:
 - Details of an effective Complaints process – to be followed *within the organisation* to address any issue raised by a learner or candidate in relation to their training and assessment
 - Description of the process available to candidates to Appeal an assessment decision
 - Details of an effective Grievance process – to be followed where an issue was not able to be handled successfully through the designated Complaints process
- Roles of staff – detailing:
 - Nomination of processes for determining job specifications and descriptions for trainers and assessors
 - Identification of tasks allocated to trainers and assessors
 - Specification of associated responsibilities
 - Integration of training and assessment activities with designated other operational imperatives within the organisation
 - Limits regarding management expectations of training and assessment roles
- Training administration requirements – as these might apply to:
 - Record keeping
 - Reporting
 - Communication
 - Budgeting and financial management
 - Compliance – with reference to external inspections and audits, and internal Quality Management protocols
- Maintenance of training content and assessments – with possible reference to:
 - Validation and moderation
 - Reviews and revisions
 - Training and assessment evaluations
 - Internal and external audits
- Information technology – addressing:
 - Systems used
 - Security
 - Software use
 - Prohibited use
 - Internet and email use
 - IT change management.



In addition a very wide range of other policies may be generated if deemed necessary. In many/most cases the standard policies which exist for the entire organisation will be deemed to also apply to the workplace training system.

In other cases there may be a need to develop separate policies, for example:



- Code of Conduct – for staff (trainers and assessors)
- Code of Conduct – for employees (as learners and candidates)
- Risk management – for deciding courses/qualifications to offer
- Education quality
- Alcohol, drugs and smoking
- Reward and recognition
- Copyright – to help prevent breaches of copyright legislation by resource developers
- LRC use
- Marketing and promotion of training
- Learner records
- Enrolment
- Credit transfers.

Websites

Take the time to read:

<http://work.chron.com/workplace-training-policy-11928.html> - Workplace training policy

http://www.industrialrelations.nsw.gov.au/oirwww/Employment_info/Managing_employees/Workplace_policies_and_procedures.page - Workplace policies and procedures.

3.2 Identify record keeping requirements within the identified workplace training system

Introduction

All workplace training systems rely on a range of records to underpin their efficient and effective operation.

This section indicates standard record keeping requirements for training-related records, and presents reasons training records need to be established and maintained.

Standard record keeping requirements

In relation to workplace training system records the following apply:

- They must be user-friendly/easy to use – in terms of:
 - Initial creation/establishment
 - Ready access
 - Updating information and data
 - Storing and/or filing
 - Retrieval of information when required
 - Archiving for future reference
 - Administering the records
- They must meet confidentiality standards – by:
 - Optimising privacy
 - Protecting personal and organisational information and data
- They must be maintained in a secure manner – which may require:
 - Protocols for issuing/releasing records and/information
 - Security of the records within the system – including protection from physical damage and/or electronic loss
- They may have to be retained for a nominated period of time – to comply with internal protocols and/or external legislated requirements
- They may be electronic or paper-based – or a combination of the two

Trainers and assessors may use and maintain paper-based records when working which are later converted to electronic format.

Some records that have to be completed for national training authorities may be available in an online format.



Websites

Check the following websites for relevant information:

http://www.transformingtraining.com.au/storage/Records%20Management%20Policy_procedures.pdf – Records Management Policy/procedures (Transforming Training RTO)

<http://www.records.nsw.gov.au/recordkeeping/advice/designing-implementing-and-managing-systems/dirks-manual/introducing-the-dirks-methodology> - Introducing the DIRKS methodology

<http://www.records.nsw.gov.au/recordkeeping/advice/information-security/how-records-management-techniques-and-skills-can-contribute-to-information-security-objectives> - How records management techniques and skills can contribute to information security objectives

Reasons to keep training-related records

Workplaces training systems can need to maintain training/assessment-related records for several reasons – such as:

- Compliance with internal organisational requirements – as specified under:
 - Internal policies
 - Operational imperatives
 - Management directives
 - Quality management system requirements, where applicable
 - Issues arising
- Compliance with externally-imposed requirements – as stipulated by:
 - Legislation
 - Training authorities
 - Stakeholder demands
 - Terms and conditions attaching to monies/donations made to the organisation
- Recording attendance – with reference to:
 - Attendances at training and assessment sessions
 - Verifying payments to employees who are eligible to be paid to attend these sessions
 - Assisting with calculations of performance management data
 - Tracking levels of engagement with the system
- Tracking participant progress – in terms of :
 - Training which has been delivered to individuals and/or relevant work-based groups
 - Details of individual difficulties with training/assessment – with reference to identified special needs issues
 - Individual assessment results
 - Recording the issuing of statements and/or certificates



- Indicating money spent – on training-related activities such as:
 - Expenditure on physical resources and consumables
 - Expenses for ancillary activities such as engaging guest speakers, travel, excursions, hire of equipment
 - Repairs and maintenance
 - Wage costs for:
 - Trainers and assessors
 - Support staff
 - Back-filling when learners and candidates attend training and assessment
- Providing objective data for system analysis – in terms of:
 - Matching actual outcomes against anticipated outcomes
 - Determining effectiveness (success or failure) of the workplace training system initiative
 - Providing information for forward planning.

Websites

Visit the following for more information:

http://www.asqa.gov.au/verve/_resources/General_direction_Retaining_student_assessment.pdf - General direction: retention requirements for completed student assessment items

<http://www.asqa.gov.au/faqs/frequently-asked-questions.html#data-and-reporting-requirements> – FAQs: Data and reporting

<http://www.asqa.gov.au/users-guide-to-the-standards-for-registered-training-organisations-2015/about-the-standards-for-rtos/standard-eight/clauses/clauses-8.1--8.2.html> - Provide requested information to ASQA'.



3.3 Produce operational training system forms to support and record workplace training delivery

Introduction

When record keeping requirements for the workplace training system are known it then remains to produce the necessary forms to support and record training and assessment provision.

This section presents standard options for documentation acquisition or production, and lists names of records which may need to exist within the system.



Standard options

Records or forms may be 'acquired' or 'generated'.

Acquiring records or forms

'Acquiring' records or forms refers to obtaining documents which have already been developed by someone else.

New workplace training systems may acquire required training and assessment documents in several ways – such as:

- Obtaining standard forms or templates from the national Training Authority – these are often available as online downloads or in hard copy versions
- Asking people in personal network of contacts for sample documents
- Seeking input from industry bodies and associations
- Purchasing *pro forma* documents from commercial providers who specialise in supplying business documentation and records
- Asking other workplaces for samples of their records
- Asking recognised training institutions for copies of records they use
- Searching online using searches targeted by individual record/document name.

Websites

See the following sites for relevant information:

<http://www.asqa.gov.au/forms.html> - Australian Government: ASQA – forms and guides

http://www.det.act.gov.au/_data/assets/pdf_file/0006/456351/Guide-1.pdf - Training Package assessment materials kit

http://www.ezyhr.com.au/training_logs.html?gclid=Ci2ZgtvRxMMCFY4svQodJCMA7w – Commercial website: ezyHR

<http://www.kzsoftware.com/products/training-manager/?gclid=CJSD5ffRxMMCFY8kvQodhxiATw> Commercial website: Kaizen Software Solutions – training records database.

Generating records/forms

'Generating' records/forms refers to:

- Creating new documents from scratch
- Modifying existing/model documents in order to meet individual need.

Keys to this process are:

- Only developing records/forms which do not already exist in usable form – do not waste time 're-inventing the wheel'
- Start the development process by making sure there is a full understanding of:
 - Why the documents need to be maintained
 - The use that will be made of the information they record
 - The detail which needs to be captured/recorded
- Follow standard document production protocols – that is:
 - Prepare a draft
 - Trial it
 - Review the effectiveness of the record in relation to the objective/s it was meant to achieve
 - Revise the draft as/if necessary
 - Test/trial the revised draft
 - Confirm effectiveness of revised draft or make further changes as required
 - Print and circulate
 - Advise/train staff in use of the record/s
 - Review utility of the document/s on a scheduled basis.



Names of records and forms

Records and forms which may need to be established and/or maintained in a workplace training system may include:

- Application forms – to enable/record:
 - Registrations of interest for training
 - Requests for assessment
- Time-table *pro formas* – showing scheduled delivery dates and times
- Training evaluation forms – designed to evaluate:
 - Training content
 - Training delivery methods
 - Training resources
 - Trainers
- Training attendance rolls – to record attendance on individual dates at specific times

- Internal audit forms – which are used to:
 - Conduct internal assessments of the training system in preparation for an external audit conducted by (for example) the Training Authority or under the Quality Management system used by the organisation
 - Record the findings of internal audits conducted by the organisation in accordance with the QMS they operate and/or to assess designated topics deemed important to the business
- Training information and advice – which may include:
 - Promotional materials to encourage engagement of employees with the training system
 - Lists of training topics
 - Course descriptions
- Learner and candidate profiles – details of individuals based on:
 - Data from personnel files
 - Input from supervisors
 - Interviews with individuals
- Competency standards – where accredited training is being provided
- Training plans and strategies – for individual learners
- Assessment plans and strategies – for individual candidates
- Session plans – for training to be delivered
- Training materials – notes, handouts, texts, manuals
- Assessment items – tests, questions, case studies, directions for practical assessments
- Budgets
- Requisitions and/or order forms
- Checklists providing evidence health, safety and welfare issues have been addressed as part of the training/assessment process
- Maintenance requests – for repairs/service to training/items
- Evidence relating to the expenditure of tagged grants or subsidies
- Internal and external audit reports
- Performance management records
- Disciplinary action records
- Completed applications made in relation to Complaints, Grievances and/or Appeals
- Fees paid – by those who pay to learn or be assessed
- Qualifications of trainers and assessors
- Agendas and Minutes of staff meetings
- Employee suggestions – in relation to training delivery and/or future courses
- Logbooks and workbooks – completed by learners



- Registration documents of the organisation as an accredited/recognised training provider, where applicable – as required by the relevant Training Authority.

Websites

Take time to visit:

<http://www.waseantourism.com/> - Training resources and competency standards for ASEAN

<https://www.jjkellertraining.com/TrainingResources/1812/OSHA> - Training records: going beyond the class sign-in sheet

http://www.training.nsw.gov.au/forms_documents/apprenticeships_traineeships/supervising_your_app_trainee.pdf - Supervising your apprentice or trainee (with special attention to the section 'What records do I need to keep?')

<https://www.business.qld.gov.au/business/employing/employee-rights-awards-entitlements/obligation-as-employer/legal-training-obligations> - Legal obligations when training staff

<http://www.training.qld.gov.au/resources/training-organisations/pdf/guide-training-plan-record.pdf> - Guide to training plans and training records.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project follows from the previous Work Project.

3.1 For the organisation/workplace identified in Work Project 1.1 develop workplace training system documents providing evidence you have:

- Developed training policies and procedures to support implementation and operation of the workplace training system
 - Identified record keeping requirements within the identified workplace training system
 - Produced operational training system forms to support and record workplace training delivery.
-

Summary

Develop workplace training system documents

When developing workplace training system documents:

- Use a team approach
- Involve stakeholders in the process
- Develop required policies to guide operation of the system
- Generate procedures to support implementation of the policies and the system
- Consider using an organisational Style Guide to guide writing
- Consider existing samples or models as the basis for developing documents
- Use templates where available
- Ensure external requirements are met
- Incorporate record keeping and reporting requirements
- Verify all operational requirements are supported by appropriate forms, records or other documents.

Element 4:

Establish procedures for the review of the workplace training system

4.1 Identify the elements of the workplace training system to be reviewed

Introduction

Workplace training systems need to be reviewed to optimise their effectiveness.

This section discusses need to review the training system, and identifies and discusses elements which may need to be reviewed.

This section forms the basis for and must be read in conjunction with all the following sections in this Element.



Reasons to review

Reviews of the workplace training system need to occur for various reasons – such as to:

- Meet compliance requirements imposed by the national Training Authority
- Conform to internal review requirements contained in relevant policies
- Determine whether or not training and assessment being conducted is meeting intended and/or actual workplace need
- Calculate degree of alignment of projections for the system with actual achievements
- Work out changes (improvements, inclusions, deletions) that need to be made to the system
- Analyse the ROI/value-for-money represented by the system
- Identify financial cost of the initiative
- Decide whether or not to continue with the workplace training system – or whether an alternate option represents a better/more preferable choice.

Elements to review

Elements of the workplace training system to be reviewed may include:

- Policies and procedures – in relation to:
 - Continuing relevancy of their content to current/changed workplace conditions or circumstances
 - Assessing whether or not there is a need for new training system policies and/or procedures to be developed

- Matching demonstrated/actual implementation of the policies and procedures against their anticipated implementation when they were formulated
- Forms and documentation – with respect to hard and soft versions to:
 - Determine if forms and documents exist to address all requirements
 - Identify if they are capable of capturing/recording required information
 - Evaluate ease of use and practical aspects (sufficient space, legibility, clarity)
 - Check compliance with internal and external requirements
 - Obtain end-user feedback
- Training delivery – with reference to suitability and effectiveness of:
 - Content of the training courses
 - Training resources and materials
 - Sequencing of topics
 - Time allocations
 - Training strategies
 - Trainers used and their individual practices and orientations
- Assessment provision – with attention paid to:
 - Assessment practices and strategies
 - Assessment items used
 - Resources used
 - Timing of assessments
 - Time allowed for assessments
 - Re-assessment protocols
 - Results achieved and identification of areas where there are significant NYC results – potentially indicating a problem either with training delivery or a lack of congruence between training provided and assessment performed
 - Workplace feedback regarding performances of those deemed to be ‘Competent’
 - Assessors used and their individual practices and orientations
- Available infrastructure to supplement training – which embraces consideration of:
 - Support services within the business
 - Administration
 - Co-operation received from supervisors/managers and the organisation in general with respect to:
 - Promoting engagement with training
 - Facilitating release of staff for training and assessment purposes
 - Assistance received in terms of on-the-job follow-up and reinforcement of training



- Feedback on progress of learners in the workplace and their readiness to move on to the next topic/unit
- Training outcomes – including:
 - Numbers of people trained and assessed
 - Contact hours delivered
 - Qualifications achieved/delivered
 - Percentage of workforce up-skilled, cross-skilled or multi-skilled
- Benefits delivered to the organisation as a result of training being undertaken – in terms of:
 - Enhanced compliance with legislated and other obligations
 - Reduced operational expenses
 - Greater productivity
 - Better product and/or service delivery to internal and external customers
 - Generating new markets and/or increased market share
 - Resources obtained from external sources
- Cost of training and assessment provision – with reference to:
 - Human resources
 - Physical resources
 - Financial resources.



4.2 Determine the frequency for reviewing identified elements within the workplace training system

Introduction

Standard practice in relation to reviews of internal systems and practices is to determine the frequency and timing of reviews.

This section identifies and discusses options for timing of the reviews.

Basic options for reviews

Elements which may be addressed as part of the reviews have been identified in the previous section.

Reviews of the workplace training system may occur:

- At the completion of individual units
- At the completion of courses
- When participants complete identified training
- In a cyclical manner
- At a designated time
- Following significant workplace change
- In response to workplace events.

At the completion of individual units

'Units' may refer to:

- A competency standard – which is sometimes referred to as a unit
- An amalgamation of training objectives on related topics which were bundled together in a logical entity.

Reviewing after every unit:

- May be excessively expensive and time consuming – especially if it is apparent the training is proving effective
- Allows regular analysis of all training delivered by the organisation – so immediate remedial action can be taken where required.



At the completion of courses

These reviews will take place when learners:

- Finish a qualification – meaning a formal/recognised certificate
- Complete a course of training – as described by the organisation, for example a group of nominated units/competencies.

Reviewing at the completion of courses:

- Provides a more holistic picture
- Takes less time and effort than reviewing after every unit
- Enables a larger pool of evidence and feedback to be used as the basis for the review/evaluation
- Allows remedial action to be taken if required prior to the commencement of the next course.



When participants complete identified training

'Identified training' is usually short-term training provided specifically to:

- Meet individual staff need – as identified as a result of internal performance management/appraisals
- Address identified/emerging workplace needs for a group of employees
- Address training gaps – as identified by TNAs.

Reviewing after identified training has been completed:

- Can be extremely time consuming – as theoretically every employee may require this type of training on potentially an on-going basis
- Greatly assist in ensuring such training is properly targeted to individual need integrated with over-arching organisational goals and constraints.

In a cyclical manner

This review option:

- Reviews nominated elements at pre-determined dates/times – as opposed to reviewing *all* elements at every review
- Means all required elements will have been reviewed (at least once) by the end of the cycle – with the cycle commonly being 12 months.

Reviewing in a cyclical manner:

- Reduces time and cost – compared to more regular reviews and/or reviewing all elements every time
- Makes sure all necessary elements are reviewed within the given timeframe – so the gap between identification of issues and their resolution is not excessive.

At a designated time

This means the review occurs at a planned time – such as:

- Every six months
- Annually.

Reviewing at designated times:

- Enables better planning for the process – because the ‘date’ is always known well in advance
- May result in incomplete evidence being captured – as reviews will often occur while training is still being delivered
- May mean important issues are not identified in a timely fashion – and problems are allowed to continue for an unacceptable period.



Following significant workplace change

Reviews following significant workplace change may take place:

- After the introduction of new equipment
- When changes are made to work practices
- If there are substantial alterations to workplace layout
- Where jobs are re-designed
- As a consequence of newly imposed legislated or other compliance requirements.

Reviews of this type:

- Are necessary to ensure compliance issues are ensured
- Are needed to maintain workforce competency with new systems, equipment and technology
- Must be undertaken to integrate new/revised training content with other training content
- Will optimise and update worker skills.

In response to workplace events

Reviews in response to workplace events may take place following:

- Workplace accidents – where someone is injured and/or property is damaged
- Identified unacceptable wastage
- Near misses – where an incident occurred but no actual injury or damage resulted
- Identification of risk which must be addressed
- Legal action – being threatened or taken by authorities, other businesses or customers.

These reviews:

- Allow targeted focus on causal factors
- Facilitate identification and integration of preventative action into standard training delivery

- Help demonstrate the organisation is discharging its Duty of Care obligations.

4.3 Allocate responsibility for implementing identified reviews of the workplace training system

Introduction

In order for reviews of the workplace training system to be effective it is necessary to allocate responsibilities for implementation.

This section identifies classifications of people who may be allocated responsibilities, and explains how these allocations may be communicated.



People who may be involved

The exact personnel who may be involved in the review process will vary between organisations/workplaces based on factors such as:

- Size of the business and its workforce
- Numbers of staff undertaking training and number of units, courses or qualifications being provided
- Whether the system is a recognised training provider or an unrecognised one
- Training and assessment-related workload of those engaged with the system
- Finance available to support the process
- Compliance obligations imposed on the system.

Those involved may be:

- From within the organisation
- From outside the organisation.

Note: Details of the activities which may need to be addressed as part of the review process will be discussed in the following section.

People from within the organisation

Internal employees with responsibility for implementing identified reviews may include:

- Trainers
- Assessors
- Support/administration staff
- Learners and candidates – including:
 - Current participants
 - Past/those who have completed training and assessments

- Those who prepare rosters – and:
 - Allocate time for staff to attend training
 - Roster staff to back-fill staff who attend training/assessment
- Senior-level management of the organisation – possibly including the Board of Management and/or representatives (where applicable) from Head Office
- Supervisors of staff who have been trained and assessed
- Co-workers of staff who have been trained and assessed
- Internal customers of those who have been trained and assessed
- Cleaners – who clean, ready and prepare training rooms/areas.



People from outside the organisation

External people who may be involved with reviews may include:

- Consultants – who are employed specifically to undertake nominated reviews and/or aspects of certain reviews
- Resource writers – who have prepared learning materials and/or assessment items
- Officials – from the Training Authority, where the organisation:
 - Is a registered/recognised training provider
 - Has received funds/grants/subsidies from the government
- Representatives from organisations, bodies or other sources who have provided resources for the system
- Customers – who have been recipients of services provided by staff who have been trained and assessed by the system
- Other businesses the organisation deals with – and who interact with employees who have been trained and assessed by the system.

Notification

Overview

Internal staff and those from outside the organisation who are not officials or designated representatives of resource providers will need to be notified of their role in the review process.

Officials or designated representatives of resource providers will undertake their review based on:

- Compliance obligations imposed by law
- Terms and conditions attaching to:
 - Contracts and agreements
 - Funding.

Communication options

Communication with those who need to be informed of their review-related roles and responsibilities can occur in one of the following, or a combination of them:

- Distributing a hard or soft copy plan or list to individuals – detailing:
 - The specific tasks/duties each person is required to undertake
 - Others involved in the same process
 - Timing requirements – when actions can/must start and time/date by which they must be completed
 - Time allowance for undertaking required action
 - Resources available to support the identified/required actions
 - Authority to take designated action
- Verbally explaining requirements – with reference to:
 - Using group meetings, one-on-one discussions and/or formal presentations
 - Detailing rationale/s for the review
 - Highlighting importance of the process
 - Stressing need to capture reliable and verifiable objective information to use as the basis for review-based decisions
 - Answering questions and concerns
- Providing relevant internal training – comprising:
 - Demonstrations of activities required
 - Role plays
 - Practice and drill.



4.4 Describe the procedures to be used in the review of the workplace training system

Introduction

Development of formal procedures to enable the scheduled reviews is a necessary pre-requisite for their implementation.

This section presents and discusses keys in a sample list of relevant procedures which are commonly used and have proved to be effective when reviewing workplace training systems.



Indicative procedures

Procedures which may be used in reviews of the workplace training system may include:

Analysis of materials and resources

This will require:

- Gathering together, reading and evaluating training and assessment items to determine:
 - Currency
 - Sufficiency
 - Clarity
 - Extent to which they meet individual and/or special needs
 - Relevancy to actual/required workplace practice
 - Utility
- Evaluating physical equipment, systems and technology used to deliver training and assessment activities – to determine:
 - Access to these resources when they are required
 - Safety
 - All factors identified under 'training and assessment items' immediately above.

Analysis of training content

Analysis of training content involves reading the training documentation and talking with trainers, assessors, learners and candidates as well as other stakeholders as appropriate to the organisation and the training system.

This aspect needs to address:

- Comparisons of training content with current workplace practices and equipment used – to verify workplace relevance and applicability
- Investigations to verify national competency standards (where used) are current versions – and they have not been superseded by a different version

- Improvements or changes which may have taken place in the industry with reference to aspects deemed relevant by the organisation – such as:
 - Best Practice innovations
 - Industry benchmarks
- Amendments made by the organisation in relation to the competency/competencies being reviewed – in terms of:
 - Criteria to be used
 - Standards to be achieved
- Sequencing of content – relating to:
 - Checking the order in which training topics are delivered
 - Verifying assessments occur sufficiently after training has occurred
- Weighting of content – with reference to:
 - Ensuring correct proportionality for important topics – and topics of lesser importance
 - Checking time and resources are allocated according to the priority of content/topics.



Analysis of participant evaluation forms

It is SOP for trainers in many workplace training systems to provide learners with evaluation forms so they can provide feedback on their thoughts and experiences with the training system.

These forms may be distributed to learners for their completion:

- After each training session
- Following completion of each topic or unit
- When a qualification or course has been finalised.

Analysis of participant evaluation forms requires:

- Gathering together and reading all the forms that were completed and returned to the trainer
- Looking for trends in the responses/criticisms and/or suggestions – as opposed to one-off comments
- Matching the comments/feedback provided to actual delivery – as this may apply to:
 - Individual trainers and their attitudes, skills and training competency
 - Specific topics, courses or qualifications
 - Content
 - Resources and materials
 - Timing and sequencing
 - Extent to which training delivered skills and knowledge required by the participants to enable them to perform their allocated workplace duties.

Interviews

Interviews are face-to-face discussions with stakeholders.

There is a view which states many *current* learners (that is, those still engaged with the training process and yet to be assessed) may be reluctant to provide legitimate negative feedback in this setting as they can believe such a response may jeopardise their assessment outcomes.



This said, interviews are a valuable source of review information – as they:

- Demonstrate reviews actually do occur in relation to the system – as opposed to simply being talked about
- Allow the non-verbal language of interviewees to be factored into contributions – so the experienced interviewer can follow-up on what seems to be an important point
- Encourage those interviewed to raise issues of their own – instead of only responding to topics identified by the interviewer.

Interviews may:

- Feature current and past participants
- Involve internal and external stakeholders
- Be conducted one-on-one or in a group content
- Be based on a standard set of questions/issues relating to the specific elements which are to be addressed by the individual review.

Analysis of operational data

Depending on the identified objectives for the training, the review may necessitate analysis of internal operational information to determine the extent to which those objectives have been achieved.

The review of this data requires:

- Acquiring base line data – which provides the benchmark against which later data can be compared
- Obtaining and evaluating information relevant to the specific objectives/elements being considered – as prescribed for the individual review
- Drawing comparisons between:
 - Progress/achievements made
 - 'Actual' results as identified by the data and 'projected' outcomes as described in the plans/training proposals.

Data which may be reviewed will need to reflect the identified objectives/projected outcomes and may relate to issues such as:

- Reduction in wastage and accidents
- Improvements in productivity and service levels
- Increased sales and/or profit margins
- Certification/compliance levels of employees.

Observation

Observation refers to visual observation of identified people whose actions are relevant to the elements being addressed by the review.

The observation may be focussed on:

- Trainers – and their training practices
- Assessors – and their assessment practices
- Workers – noting their level of competency in the workplace
- Customers – noting their reaction/response to being served by staff who have been trained.

Observation may feature:

- Physically watching people – individuals or groups
- Using a checklist to record targeted data – as required in relation to the elements being covered by the review
- Recording action observed – for later playback and more detailed analysis.



Analysis of feedback received

Feedback provided to the system by those who are using and/or impacted by the system is valuable for all reviews.

It is important to ensure:

- The system must be proactive in soliciting feedback – the system must never just rely on feedback which is *offered* to it
- All feedback must be considered – not just the positive contributions
- Stakeholders are given a variety of feedback options – as opposed to, for example, *requiring* them to provide formal/written input
- Contributions are sought from all stakeholders – as relevant to the nature of the review being conducted/the elements being researched
- Analysis of training-related feedback, including complaints, grievances, awards received.

Meeting with stakeholders

Meetings with stakeholders for the purposes of review will require:

- Organising and scheduling the meeting/s – to ensure all stakeholders attend and are given the opportunity to participate
- Providing advance notice – with reference to:
 - Elements and issues to be addressed
 - Expectations about contributions the stakeholders will make – for example, that:
 - Contributions are valid/legitimate
 - Comments are honest and without bias or malice
 - Input needs to be able to be justified/supported by evidence
- Recording the contributions made – noting relevant remarks which may relate to:
 - Levels of satisfaction with training and assessment provision
 - Suggestions and reasons for change/improvements
 - Identification of who made contributions – because it is often a fact of life the thoughts of certain stakeholders carry more weight/influence than the feedback of others.



4.5 Document approved procedures for review of the workplace training system

Introduction

The procedures to be used when conducting reviews of the workplace training system must always be documented.

This section examines the reasons to document the procedures, identifies possible criteria and/or standards which might apply, and describes ways in which the procedures may be shared with those who need to implement them.

Need to document the procedures to be used

'Documenting the procedures to be used' in the review process means developing them in written form, as opposed to allowing them to:

- Exist only in spoken form
- Exist only in the mind/s of those with ultimate responsibility for the process.

The procedures to be used in the review process must be documented in order to:

- Facilitate communication of the required procedures – with the potentially wide range of participants
- Describe the elements of the system which need to be reviewed – as appropriate to individual reviews
- Ensure there is certainty amongst those who have been allocated responsibilities – about exactly what they are expected to do
- Allow challenges to be made to proposed procedures – and questions asked about the process
- Make sure there is consistency in the action taken – so all participants are 'on the same page' about what is required and what is seeking to be achieved
- Guarantee all required aspects/elements of the review are addressed
- Integrate the diversity of activities which need to be undertaken – so the review represents a cohesive/seamless 'whole'
- Provide proof all *required* aspects of the review have been addressed – so the review actually addresses all the identified elements for the review.



Criteria and/or standards which might apply

Documentation generated to describe approved procedures for reviews should/could:

- Identify the type and nature of the review – to provide context to those who are involved
- Specify all the elements which need to be addressed – within the review process
- Detail targets for action – such as individuals, groups or data contained (for example) in business/operational documents, registers and rolls, feedback forms
- Nominate review parameters – in terms of dates and time/s for initiation and finalisation of activities
- Explain the type and detail of analysis required as part of the review – such as:
 - Assembling data
 - Manipulating data
 - Assessing and evaluating data
 - Presenting results/findings
- Differentiate between acceptable and unacceptable data – which may require:
 - Quantification of data to be gathered to enable a valid review to occur
 - Description of legitimate data – with examples of irrelevant data
- Designate person/persons to contact – in the event:
 - Difficulties are encountered – with implementing the requirements of the process
 - Ambiguous information/data is identified – and there is a need to determine if it is valid for the purposes of the review or not
- Supply acceptable samples of evidence, data, recording sheets, checklists and similar completed as part of previous similar reviews – to give participants a model of what they are trying to achieve, capture or generate.



Sharing the procedures

Options for sharing approved procedures with those who need to implement them may involve:

- Distributing hard copy information – in the form of:
 - Checklists
 - Step-by-step actions
- Verbally advising those involved – with a focus on:
 - Detailing requirements and describing actions
 - Explaining acceptable evidence
- Supplementing hard copy and verbal information – with;
 - Training
 - Demonstrations

- Drills.

4.6 Obtain management commitment to implement required changes to the workplace training system

Introduction

Findings of reviews of workplace training systems commonly require management approval before they can be implemented.

This section presents considerations and possible actions in this regard.



Considerations

The following points will need to be considered in relation to gaining management approval to implement changes to a workplace training system:

- Required changes issuing from certain sources will tend receive a more positive response from management – for example:
 - Findings made as a result of an external audit by Training Authorities – as continued registration as a recognised provider (and the potential to receive on-going government support/funding) depend on complying with these demands
 - Results of a QMS audit (or audit by an industry accreditation body) – in order to maintain the reputation, registration and/or credibility of the business
 - Key stakeholders always have more influence than non-key stakeholders
- Those requesting the changes need to fully understand what is required – because they will/may have to:
 - Explain them to others
 - Generate options for solving/implementation
 - Actually implement the required/approved changes
- Management must be given sufficient advance notice of the need for change – so they can:
 - Consider the request/requirements
 - Determine options
 - Make decisions
- The application for management approval to proceed and the request for them to commit to the required changes needs to be planned – time and effort needs to be taken to:
 - Determine the pitch
 - Decide timing and location for the request/s
 - Prepare supporting materials to prove/demonstrate need and/or benefits.

Obtaining management approval and commitment

There may be a need to:

- Provide copies of audit reports together with required changes – to prove the changes which are required
- Estimate costs associated with making the changes – in terms of (as appropriate):
 - Initial expenses
 - On-going and associated costs
- Describe and quantify consequences if the organisation elects not to proceed with making identified changes – so the potential downside is presented
- Run a cost-benefit analysis in relation to the changes – to show and quantify positive outcomes expected to flow from making the changes
- Make a personal presentation – to management/the Board in order to:
 - Describe the context and situation
 - Explain the proposed changes
 - Respond to questions
- Generate options – for making the required changes in an acceptable manner rather than just focussing on one/obvious approach or choice
- Undertake further research or reviews – to generate/capture more information or more relevant data as identified by management before they feel they are able to grant approval to implement
 - Obtain definite authority to proceed – this:
 - Highlights approval to implement can never be assumed
 - May involve being provided with appropriately signed *written* approval
 - Should be filed for future reference
- Identify and/or be advised of resources available to enable required implementation – so the means to implement the changes have been allocated and authorised.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project follows from the previous Work Project.

4.1 For the organisation/workplace identified in Work Project 1.1 establish procedures for the review of the workplace training system providing evidence you have:

- Identified the elements of the workplace training system to be reviewed
- Determined the frequency for reviewing identified elements within the workplace training system
- Allocated responsibility for implementing identified reviews of the workplace training system
- Described the procedures to be used in the review of the workplace training system
- Documented approved procedures for review of the workplace training system
- Obtained management commitment to implement required changes to the workplace training system.

Summary

Establish procedures for the review of the workplace training system

When establishing procedures for the review of the workplace training system:

- Identify elements of the system which need to be reviewed
- Develop operational protocols to guide the review
- Allocate responsibilities and resources for review processes
- Specify the type/s of reviews which will be used
- Nominate the frequency with which reviews will occur
- Comply with externally imposed requirements
- Determine a schedule for the review
- Communicate review requirements
- Train staff in review procedures
- Use a team approach
- Document all procedures
- Obtain required approvals for all review procedures
- Gain commitment from management to implement required changes as identified by the review process.

Element 5:

Prepare to implement the workplace training system

5.1 Develop an implementation plan for the training system

Introduction

An implementation plan should always be prepared to facilitate and guide the implementation of all workplace training systems.

This section identifies the need for an implementation plan, and discusses traditional content of the plan.

Need for an implementation plan

A formal, written implementation plan should be developed for the following reasons:

- Planned workplace change has a greater chance of success – than unplanned change
- The plan provides the platform for explaining the initiative and its introduction to employees – so they can better understand the initiative
- A written plan facilitates effective sharing of information – so everyone receives the same information
- Planning demonstrates professionalism and shows the initiative has been properly considered, thought through and prepared for
- The plan gives those with responsibilities under the plan details of what they are required to do
- Generating such a plan forces the proposers of the system to properly analyse the implementation of the system – and anticipate problems/difficulties so appropriate action to address and overcome them can be taken
- To ensure necessary resources to enable the implementation of the initiative can be identified – and action taken to obtain what is needed.



Contents of the implementation plan

General format/layout

There is no standard template for the development of implementation plans.

The implementation plan created for the workplace training system will normally be prepared using the format, layout or template used by the organisation for the presentation of other plans used by the business.

Implementation plans for implementation of a workplace training system normally contain:



- Standard plan-related facts – including:
 - Name of plan – ‘Plan for implementing a workplace training system into XYZ workplace’
 - Date the plan was approved by management – giving authority to proceed
 - Names of key people who developed the plan
 - Brief rationale for the initiative
 - Brief mention of benefits expected to flow
 - Version control details
- General system-related information and overview – in terms of, for example:
 - Glossary of terms
 - Whether system is recognised or non-recognised as an accredited provider
 - Overview of what the system will provide
 - Details of assumptions and constraints which have impacted development of the system
 - Organisation and structure of the system
 - Expected training and assessment outcomes for the first period/year
- Standard operational plan headings – which provide the sections under which the specifics of the plan are identified:
 - Objectives – specification of activities or steps or stage to be undertaken or completed to enable implementation: see below
 - Timeframe – for every objective which will provide:
 - Start and finish dates
 - Completion dates for identified milestones
 - Sequence in which activities need to be done
 - Person/s responsible – for action described in the plan. These may be:
 - Internal to the organisation – in terms of individuals or groups/teams
 - External bodies, partners, consultants, providers, or identified stakeholders
 - Budget and resources available – in terms of:
 - Funding
 - Physical resources

- Information/data to enable action to be taken.

Phases

Customary content contained in implementation plans for workplace training systems should consider three distinct phases of implementation:

- The Introductory phase – where the system commences/starts up within the workplace and participants are totally new to the system and how it operates
- The Transitional phase – where participants are aware of the system and how it operates but are not totally familiar with all aspects of it and are still trying to integrate the demands of the system with their normal day-to-day working life
- The Consolidation phase – where the system has been fully bedded down and is totally operational as intended and all participants are conversant with how it works and their (potential) roles and opportunities within it.

Objectives

Traditional objectives will need to address:

- Promotion of the training system – which refers to activities (under, for example a formal Communications Plan/Program) designed to make the workplace (and possible other targeted external learners and candidates) aware of the initiative – this will require:
 - Communicating internally with employees and interested parties – for example:
 - Holding information sessions specific to the initiative to describe its introduction and operation
 - Raising the new workplace training systems in staff meetings and briefings
 - Promoting the benefits of the system to the organisation, employees and customers
 - Encouraging engagement with the system
 - Inviting questions from interested parties/individuals
 - Conducting tours of the training facilities
 - Explaining the support available for participants
 - Communicating the initiative externally – by, for example:
 - Using the media to notify the general public
 - Advertising on the organisation website
 - Mentioning on social media
 - Notifying industry bodies, the Training Authority and registered training institutions
- Development of formal protocols required to support the system – which may require preparation of:
 - Training and assessment-specific policies and procedures
 - Integration of new protocols with existing policies and procedures to ensure seamless operation of all requirements



- Compliance with externally imposed requirements where the organisation is registering as an RTO/ATO and/or has received funding from government or industry bodies
- Preparation of trainers and assessors – see next section for more, but will address:
 - Identifying suitable internal personnel
 - Confirming and recruiting suitable internal personnel
 - Engaging suitable external personnel
 - Providing necessary induction and training for identified staff
- Preparation of training programs – to reflect identified need as previously determined (see section 5.3 for more detail), involving:
 - Ensuring training matches identified competency requirements
 - Developing required competency standards
 - Identifying training need for individual participants
 - Designing the program
 - Scheduling/preparing time-tables for training and assessments
- Acquisition of resources to support training and assessment delivery – see section 5.4 for more detail, but this will need to address:
 - Researching and acquiring externally available, commercially produced materials – such as:
 - Notes and manuals
 - Assessment items
 - Developing *internally* the training and assessment materials and items necessary to:
 - Enable targeted training in accordance with the prepared training programs
 - Support workplace-based assessment of competency
- Recruitment of participants – which may involve (see section 5.5):
 - Reviewing of existing qualification and competencies
 - Identifying and inviting learners to training
 - Identifying and inviting candidates for assessment
 - Holding information sessions
 - Mandating attendance/participation
- Registration with the Training Authority as a recognised provider (where applicable) – which will require conformance with local requirements which may relate to:
 - Description of the organisation and the products/services it provides
 - Determination of Scope of Registration for the system
 - Explanation of governance of the system to ensure it will comply with registration requirements on an on-going basis



- Demonstration of how the system will cooperate with the Training Authority with reference to nominated activities such as:
- Audits conducted by the Training Authority
- Provision of required data to the Training Authority
- Communication of notifiable changes – in relation to operation of the to the system and ownership of the organisation
- Records management
- Reporting to the Training Authority
 - Evidence of compliance with all applicable legislation – relating to:
 - Workplace operations including health, safety and welfare
 - Training and assessment
- Business/corporate management and operations
 - Proof of relevant insurance as prescribed by the Training Authority – in that an RTO/ATO must carry sufficient and appropriate public liability insurance
 - Financial management and viability of the organisation during its period of registration – with reference to, for example:
 - Demonstrating of financial viability of, and/or financial projections for, the organisation
 - Supplying details of (where applicable) the Fees and Charges proposed
- Providing draft policies (if applicable – that is, where the system has decided to provide training to external participants, assessments for external candidates) for Payment of Fees, Refunds and guarantees to complete any qualifications which are started by learners
 - Evidence of how the system intends to address certification of candidates and the issuance of qualifications and/or Statement of Attainment – with reference to:
- Identifying how candidates will be determined as ‘C’ or ‘NYC’ in relation to accredited competency standards
- Describing how and when qualifications and Statements of Attainment will be issued
- Agreeing to the use of required terminology and Training Authority logos on qualifications and Statements of Attainment
- Maintaining records for the time period set by the Training Authority
- Agreeing to replace qualifications and Statements of Attainment for those who have been awarded them
- Notifying the Training Authority of qualifications and Statements of Attainment issued
 - Agreement the organisation will recognise other credentials issued by other RTOs/ATOs under the relevant system
 - Agreement the organisation will only engage in ethical practices when promoting its courses and/or recruiting learners and candidates



- Conformity to nominated registration Standards as set by the Training Authority for all RTOs/ATOs – Training Authority requirements are usually outcome-based so it the duty of the organisation to determine and describe the actions it will take to implement them.

Requirements which may need to be addressed in the implementation plan may relate to:

- Provision of responsive, quality training and assessment – and:
 - Implementation of a comprehensive training and assessment strategy
 - Engagement with industry
 - Learner support
 - Effective assessment – see more in section 5.3
 - Use of skilled and expert trainers and assessors
 - Learner supervision



See <http://www.asqa.gov.au/users-guide-to-the-standards-for-registered-training-organisations-2015/about-the-standards-for-rtos/standard-one/standard-one.html> - Users' Guide to the Standards for RTOs 2015 (including reference to all Clauses provided for under this Standard)

- Quality assurance – with reference to:
 - Implementation of QA strategies
 - Monitoring of independent third parties

See <http://www.asqa.gov.au/users-guide-to-the-standards-for-registered-training-organisations-2015/about-the-standards-for-rtos/standard-two/standard-two.html> - Users' Guide to the Standards for RTOs 2015 (including reference to all Clauses provided for under this Standard)

- Certification of qualifications – with reference to:
 - Provision of secure certification
 - Provision of credit for prior studies
 - Participation in Training Authority schemes to identify learners

See <http://www.asqa.gov.au/users-guide-to-the-standards-for-registered-training-organisations-2015/about-the-standards-for-rtos/standard-three/standard-three.html> - Users' Guide to the Standards for RTOs 2015 (including reference to all Clauses provided for under this Standard)

- Provision of transparent and accurate information to stakeholders

See <http://www.asqa.gov.au/users-guide-to-the-standards-for-registered-training-organisations-2015/about-the-standards-for-rtos/standard-four/standard-four.html> - Users' Guide to the Standards for RTOs 2015 (including reference to Clause provided for under this Standard)

- Principles of access and equity and the protection and supervision of learners

See <http://www.asqa.gov.au/users-guide-to-the-standards-for-registered-training-organisations-2015/about-the-standards-for-rtos/standard-five/standard-five.html> - Users' Guide to the Standards for RTOs 2015 (including reference to all Clauses provided for under this Standard)

- Complaints, grievances and appeals

See <http://www.asqa.gov.au/users-guide-to-the-standards-for-registered-training-organisations-2015/about-the-standards-for-rtos/standard-six/standard-six.html> - Users' Guide to the Standards for RTOs 2015 (including reference to all Clauses provided for under this Standard)



- Effective management and governance

See <http://www.asqa.gov.au/users-guide-to-the-standards-for-registered-training-organisations-2015/about-the-standards-for-rtos/standard-seven/standard-seven.html> - Users' Guide to the Standards for RTOs 2015 (including reference to all Clauses provided for under this Standard)

- Legal compliance

See <http://www.asqa.gov.au/users-guide-to-the-standards-for-registered-training-organisations-2015/about-the-standards-for-rtos/standard-eight/standard-eight.html> - Users' Guide to the Standards for RTOs 2015 (including reference to all Clauses provided for under this Standard)

See more detail regarding examples of what may be required for registration as a recognised provider at:

<http://www.asqa.gov.au/users-guide-to-the-standards-for-registered-training-organisations-2015/faqs/faqs.html> Users' Guide to the Standards for RTOs 2015 FAQs

<http://www.asqa.gov.au/users-guide-to-the-standards-for-registered-training-organisations-2015/about-the-standards-for-rtos/about-the-standards-for-rtos.html> - About the Standards for RTOs 2015

http://www.asqa.gov.au/verve/_resources/Users_Guide_to_the_Standards_for_Registered_Training_Organisations_RTOs_2015.pdf - Users' Guide: Standards for RTOs 2015

http://www.asqa.gov.au/verve/_resources/Application_guide_-_Application_for_initial_RTO_registration.pdf - Application Guide: application for initial RTO registration

- Establishment of the training environment within the workplace, where necessary – with reference to:
 - Building a training room and/or department
 - Acquiring standard training items (equipment, technology and consumables) to equip the training room/department
 - Conducting trials and tests of systems, technology and equipment for use in training and assessment.

5.2 Prepare trainers and assessors in accordance with identified need

Introduction

All trainers and assessors who will operate/work in the workplace training system must be prepared in accordance with identified need.

This section highlights the importance of this step, and describes activities which may be required to ensure this occurs.



The importance of this step

Trainers and assessors must be prepared in accordance with identified need in order to:

- Meet externally imposed requirements (where applicable) for trainers and assessors to:
 - Hold nominated vocational training and/or vocational assessment qualifications
 - Have the minimum mandated years of experience or nominated work experience
- Ensure the proposed training and assessment program can be delivered – as planned
- Give learners and candidates (and other stakeholders) confidence in the outcomes which will be provided by the system – as a result of using credible trainers and assessors with relevant work and vocational training expertise
- Make sure they are aware of all applicable operational imperatives and/or constraints – as these may apply to, for example:
 - Standards imposed by the Training Authority
 - Policies and procedures of the organisation operating the system
 - Budgets
 - Documentation to be used and/or completed as part of:
 - Planning and preparation
 - Training delivery
 - Assessment
 - Reporting
 - Reviews and evaluations
 - Time-tables/delivery schedules
 - Training content and/or required competency standards
 - Individual roles and responsibilities – with reference to:
 - Internal (and external, where applicable) reporting and communication
 - Liaising with other staff
 - Record keeping.

Activities required

It is possible the following items may be part of the activities required to prepare trainers and assessors for their roles in a workplace training system:

- Identifying suitable internal personnel – who:
 - Hold the necessary work-related qualifications
 - Have the necessary industry experience and ability
 - Present the potential to function as trainers and assessors
 - May already hold an acceptable vocational training and/or assessment qualification
- Confirming availability of identified personnel – considering factors such as:
 - Willingness to work as a trainers and/or assessor
 - Ability of a department or the organisation to release them from other duties to undertake training and assessing roles
 - Possible impact on service delivery to customers through the transfer of people from operations to a training/assessment position
 - Potential to engage existing operational staff as (for example) 0.5 time-fraction in their normal service/production role and 0.5 as trainer and/or trainer
 - Capacity of the organisation to back-fill operational staff who may be transferred to training and/or assessment duties with suitable others
- Engaging external training and assessment personnel – which may include:
 - Recruiting suitable and sufficient staff
 - Selecting and hiring fully-qualified and appropriately experienced staff – where there is no viable in-house option
 - Conducting induction and orientation procedures with new employees
 - Making new staff aware of the organisation-specific operational requirements and constraints which apply to the function of the workplace training system
- Providing the necessary training for identified internal staff – who do not hold:
 - Mandatory training and assessment credentials as stipulated by the Training Authority
 - Certification in accordance with identified in-house minimum requirements in this regard



- Providing trainers and assessors with appropriate opportunities – as required to:
 - Visit other/established workplace training systems to
 - Observe their activities
 - View their facilities
 - Talk to staff/establish a network of personal contacts
 - Gain tips, advice and insights into training and assessment delivery
 - Gain expertise and experience deemed necessary for the content to be delivered – where the personnel are deemed to be deficient in certain topics/areas
 - Learn about the content and interpret competency standards to be delivered – so courses/training can be effectively and efficiently conducted
 - Establish contacts and professional networks and peer group support with identified stakeholders
 - Attend professional development activities focusing on best practice in assessment and/or workplace training
 - Review information which formed the basis of the decision to establish a workplace training system
 - Meet with identified learners – to identify their individual needs/preferences and learning styles
 - Develop appropriate learning and assessment plans and strategies – to address identified need
 - Trial/test, review and (where necessary) revise training delivery and assessment materials, strategies and options
 - Conduct pilot courses.



5.3 Prepare training programs to provide identified training

Introduction

The basis of training provision in any workplace training system is the suite of training programs developed by the organisation for its employees.

This section defines 'training programs', lists the basis for the development of such programs, highlights the relationship between training programs and assessment, and identifies activities inherent in the process.

Training programs

The term 'training program' does not have a standard/generally accepted definition – it is open to interpretation by those who use the term.

It is also possible the meaning of the term will vary over time as the training content being provided by the workplace system varies – what is a training program today may not be the same thing in 12 months' time.

Training programs may be seen as:

- Courses/qualifications delivered by a provider
- Topics/content delivered as part of wider training – for example, certain Elements of recognised competency standards
- An individual competency standard/unit or a designated group of competency standards which is less than the requirements for the awarding of a qualification
- Short courses or longer-term courses
- Recognised/accredited training or non-recognised/accredited training.

It is important to determine how this term is understood in the individual workplace so that:

- There is clarity about its use
- There is no confusion about what it means and what it includes
- All people using the term are referring to the same thing.



Basis for development of training programs

Regardless of the specific definition or interpretation of the term, training programs must always, in order to be effective, be based on:

- Competency standards provided by the relevant Training Authority – where the workplace training system is a recognised/accredited training provider
- Competencies, standards and criteria identified by the individual workplace – as this may apply to:
 - The right of recognised/accredited training providers to modify competency standards to suit individual workplace (or industry) need
 - Non-endorsed elements of accredited training packages
- Identified individual employee need – of learners as determined by, for example:
 - TNAs
 - Skills audits and analysis
 - Compliance-related need
 - Self-disclosure of need by individual workers
 - Observations of management and supervisors
 - Feedback/comments from customers and co-workers
- Organisational need – as determined with reference to:
 - Business plans
 - Strategic targets
 - Operational imperatives
 - Identified Opportunities open to the business
 - Identified Threats facing the business
 - HR planning requirements.



Relationship between training programs and assessment

Several options exist in relation to the relationship which may exist between training programs and the assessment which conducted by the workplace system – for example:

- The workplace may opt to provide internal assessment for all the training programs delivered by the organisation – covering, as appropriate:
 - Recognised/accredited training
 - Non- recognised/accredited training
- The organisation may decide to out-source all assessment services – to:
 - A professional external consultant with appropriate qualifications and experience
 - A suitable recognised/accredited training provider

- Where the system is not a recognised/accredited provider the organisation may elect to conduct no formal assessment for those who have undertaken training – but may use an informal approach featuring, perhaps:

- On-the-job observations of performance
- Discussions with supervisors and co-workers regarding the competency of the individual



- Use different people to provide the training and do the assessment for that training – so there is separation of responsibilities.

Some people believe it is unacceptable for the person who conducts the assessment to be the same person who delivered the training.

Some people are quite happy to use the same person to undertake both training and assessment for the same training program/content.

Activities in the process

Preparing training programs may include:

- Reviewing existing/endorsed competency standards to be used – to:
 - Learn the requirements for each unit and/or qualification
 - Identify resources required
 - Determine modifications required/allowable to customise competency standards to meet individual workplace needs
- Developing new competency standards necessary to meet internal requirements – where:
 - The organisation is not operating a system recognised by the national Training Authority
 - No suitable recognised competency standards exist and the Training Authority allows additional content to be provided as part of the delivery of qualifications under its training/qualifications framework
- Designing the program – which may involve:
 - Sequencing of content
 - Time allocations for delivery of topics
 - Identification of competencies combined into training units/modules
 - Integration of common competencies across different courses/qualifications – to optimise efficiency of delivery and lower training costs/time
 - Selection of training delivery strategies and methods – see below
 - Determination of assessment to be undertaken

- Scheduling/preparing time-tables – for:
 - Training and assessments
 - Individuals and groups
 - Every topic/qualification ('training program' however defined by the organisation)
- Developing training plans – for individual learners
- Developing assessments, assessment items and/or assessment plans – for individual candidates
- Developing session plans – to guide the delivery of individual training sessions.



Identification of training methods/strategies

Trainers have the right and freedom to choose whatever training methods and strategies they want when delivering training.

Important issues

Important considerations when selecting training methods/strategies are that the options chosen:

- Should reflect any known learning preferences of the learners – this is ideally the case but often not possible
- Need to be appropriate to the content of the individual competency standard being presented
- Must enable delivery to occur within the known parameters – especially in relation to budget and time
- Should address and reflect the known assessment requirements for the competency standard – as discussed with the Assessor/s who will conduct assessments for the content
- Should introduce diversity into the training and help motivate learners – to help avoid learner boredom
- Must be able to be accommodate all the learners – and not just some/a selected few
- Have to reflect the availability of supporting physical resources
- Will often be selected to best fit with individual Trainer:
 - Personality
 - Preference for teaching methods.

Options for training delivery

Different training delivery methods have different applicability for training of:

- Skill
- Knowledge
- Attitude.

Options for training delivery methods together with considerations which may influence their use for training delivery include:

- Demonstration
- Lecture
- Brainstorming
- Role plays
- Case study
- Group discussion
- Questioning
- Excursions/field trips
- Practice/drill.



Assessment

Planning of training programs also needs to consider the assessment to be provided.

Evidence is gathered to demonstrate competence in the skills and knowledge required by the units of competency.

Standard requirements

It is necessary where CBA is being undertaken that:

- The recognised 'Principles of Assessment' are applied – that is:
 - Fairness
 - Flexibility
 - Validity
 - Reliability
- The required 'Rules of Evidence' are followed – that is:
 - Validity
 - Sufficiency
 - Authenticity
 - Currency.

See more detail in relation to the above at <http://www.asqa.gov.au/users-guide-to-the-standards-for-registered-training-organisations-2015/about-the-standards-for-rtos/standard-one/clauses/clauses-1.8--1.12.html> - Users' Guide to the Standards for RTOs 2015.

Assessment options

Practical skills may be assessed through:

- Real work – observation, using:
 - Checklists
 - Projects
 - Project teams
 - On-the-job practical tasks
- Simulated work/demonstrations – observation, using:
 - Checklists
 - Projects
 - Assignments
 - Role Plays
- Analysis/evaluation of finished products, items, documentation – produced by candidates.

Knowledge may be assessed using:

- Written format – such as:
 - Multiple choice questions
 - Short answer questions
 - Assignments
 - Projects
 - Essays
 - True/False questions
- Oral format – such as:
 - Oral questions
 - Role plays
 - Interviews
 - Presentations by the learner
 - Discussion groups
 - On- and off-the-job questions.



Assessment tools

To collect evidence 'assessment tools' (also known as 'assessment items') will need to be used.

These tools are used to collect and interpret evidence of competence

Assessment tools can be used in combination or by themselves provided that they 'test, measure' the competency.

Assessment tools will reflect the nature of the assessment method/s to be used – for example:

- If doing an 'Interview' a Questionnaire might be used
- If conducting an observation of learner actions, a Checklist could be used
- If watching a demonstration, a Checklist would be suitable
- If asking Oral Questions a sheet listing the questions and able to capture answers would be used.



5.4 Obtain resources to support training delivery

Introduction

Resources will always need to be obtained to enable the delivery of training and the conduct of assessments.

This section identifies resources which may need to be obtained, discusses relevant considerations relating to resources and examines the processes of obtaining/developing necessary resources.

Resources

Generic resources

'Generic resources' are those which exist in a normal classroom situation/standard training environment.

They include:

- Furniture, fixture and fittings
- Desks and chairs
- White boards and chalk boards
- Data projectors and overhead projectors and screens
- Computers and printers with relevant software/programs
- Photocopiers
- Consumables – paper, ink, pens, whiteboard markers, overhead pens.



Competency-specific resources

These are resources specific to the competency standard/topic being delivered.

Examples include:

- Manuals, notes and handouts for individual competency standards
- Raw materials – food and drinks, blank forms/documents
- Sample products, items, equipment and utensils
- Projection/acetate sheets – for use with overhead projectors
- PowerPoint slides/presentations
- Projects, case studies, worked examples, exercises, role play scenarios
- Videos and DVDs
- Relevant facilities – for example:
 - A fully-functional office for many of the travel and tourism competencies
 - Vehicles for driving-related competency standards
 - Camping and touring equipment for tour operations competencies.

Important considerations when obtaining resources

It is important to ensure:

- Host country legislation is obtained – where competency standards refer to legislation there is a need to obtain the legislation applicable to the country where the qualification/unit is being delivered
- Industry relevance – all forms, documentation, examples and samples must represent what is being used in the industry/organisation
- ‘Sufficient’ resources are available – there will nearly always be some need for learners to share certain resources and this requirement needs to be factored into the session plans which are developed but there will also always some basic minimum number of items which are essential and without which the training cannot take place
- All resources are safe to use – this is the single most critical element relating to physical resources used for training
- Resources are current – they need to reflect the items used in the industry/organisation the learners are working in.



Resources and training materials – preparation, development and acquisition

Preparation and development

Basic options

Readying resources and materials to support training may necessitate:

- Generating them from scratch
- Revising existing materials
- Using again items which have been previously used.

Essential standards

It is vital to ensure in all of the above situations the resources/materials:

- Reflect individual student need – learning style/preference and/or requirement for extra content
- Address identified individual workplace need – to provide organisation-specific information
- Are current, comprehensive and accurate
- Respond to special needs of different learner groups
- Cover the specifics of the competency standard/s being delivered
- Can be created within the allowable budget
- Wherever possible, can be re-used in other sessions and/or by other trainers.

Options for acquiring training resources

The following options exist for acquiring training resources:

- Purchase them – from professional suppliers of training support materials
- Ask suppliers to donate
- Request loan of them from industry partners, carriers, or bodies
- Conduct excursions/field trips to workplaces and use what is available at those locations
- Share them (and the cost of purchase) – with other training providers and/or organisations that have a workplace training system
- Seek government funding for their acquisition.

Websites

See the following for more information:

<http://www.waseantourism.com/> - ASEAN-Australia Development Cooperation Program Phase II: Repository for resources produced by William Angliss Institute

http://corporatetrainingmaterials.com/pages/training_library.asp - Commercial site

<http://www.futuragroup.com.au> - Commercial site

<http://www.didasko.com/sit12.php> - Commercial site.



5.5 Recruit participants for training

Introduction

An on-going need for every workplace training system is the requirement to identify and notify participants about available training.

This section presents activities which may be involved in recruiting employees who may require and/or benefit from participation.

Recruitment activities

Activities which may be involved in the recruitment of participants/employees for the workplace training system can include:

- Reviewing existing qualification and competencies of staff – to determine:
 - Are they current?
 - Are they relevant?
 - Are they sufficient?
 - Are they compliant?
 - Is refresher and/or update training required?
- Identifying potential learners – on the basis of:
 - Formal analysis
 - Requests from employees for training
 - Management directives
 - Mandatory requirements established by the organisation for jobs as stated in job descriptions/internal documents
- inviting learners to training – using:
 - One-to-one discussions
 - Explanations of need
 - Illustration of benefits flowing from and support for training
 - Scheduling and organising their attendance with their supervisor/manager
- Identifying and inviting candidates for assessment – where there:
 - Is need for the system to formally assess worker qualifications
 - Is facility to embrace RPL and/or RCC
 - May be revenue to be earned from conducting vocational assessments
- Holding information sessions – for:
 - All staff
 - Targeted groups and individuals
 - Key stakeholders
 - Media
 - Training and business partners



- Mandating attendance/participation – with reference to:
 - Advising staff that participating in required training is a condition of employment
 - Explaining all required training is conducted during paid working hours and is provided free-of-charge by the organisation
 - Identifying timing of training dates and projected duration of training
- Notifying staff in advance – regarding:
 - Their obligation to attend training
 - Identification of training venues/locations
 - Specification of individual training and assessment times
 - Duration of training/assessment
 - Training topics/content.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project follows from the previous Work Project.

5.1 For the organisation/workplace identified in Work Project 1.1 prepare to implement the workplace training system by providing evidence you have:

- Developed an implementation plan for the training system
 - Prepared trainers and assessors in accordance with identified need
 - Prepared training programs to provide identified training
 - Obtained resources to support training delivery
 - Recruited participants for training.
-

Summary

Prepare to implement the workplace training system

When preparing to implement the workplace training system:

- Use a team approach
- Develop a formal implementation plan
- Allocate resources and responsibilities
- Set clear objectives and actions
- Nominate timelines for implementation
- Ensure compliance with internal operational requirements
- Comply with external implementation obligations
- Prepare the trainers and assessors to be used
- Develop required training programs in accordance with identified internal need and/or external compliance standards
- Create documentation to support training, assessment and required administration
- Establish infrastructure to enable training and assessment to be delivered
- Develop and/or acquire training materials/resources and assessment items
- Recruit learners and candidates for the system
- Promote the system to stakeholders and potential users.

Element 6: Establish quality assurance procedures for the workplace training system

6.1 Establish a quality assurance group

Introduction

Standard practice for all workplace training systems is to have quality assurance procedures in place to manage the operation of the system.

This section gives a context for this requirement, positions QA within a wider Quality Management framework, describes activities involved in establishing the QA group, identifies those who may be part of the group, and describes the role of the group.

The context for quality

It is important to understand:

- Quality Management of the workplace training system should extend across all aspects of activities and performance – not just selected aspects
- The Quality Management System represents a planned, ongoing process aimed at ensuring quality and improving outcomes for learners, the organisation and stakeholders
- The Quality Management System must be evidence-based
- Quality Management will be fundamental to achieving the organisation's mission
- Quality Management provides a platform for future development, meeting future workforce needs and maintaining the reputation and operational capacity of the organisation
- Quality management is generally a key aspect of initial and ongoing registration requirements for accreditation/recognition by the Training Authority.



Quality management

Quality Assurance is one part of an effective Quality Management System built around three principles:

- Quality Assurance
- Continuous Quality Improvement
- Quality Leadership.

Through its Quality Assurance activities the organisation ensures that all training and assessment quality requirements are met.



Through its Continuous Quality Improvement processes the organisation is systematically reviewing its training and assessment activities and identifying improvements.

Through Quality leadership the organisation is moving beyond compliance and continuous quality improvement to a space where it is aiming to set benchmarks and levels of excellence to which others will aspire.

See more under 'Key Activities' and 'Goals' in the following section.

Activities involved in establishing the Quality Management group

Establishing a quality assurance group may include:

- Identifying participants – who can make worthwhile contributions to the group: see below
- Explaining the role of quality management within the training system – so there is:
 - Genuine understanding of the meaning of quality management as it related to training and assessment as opposed to the meaning of quality with respect to other operations of the business
 - Clear and definite appreciation of the responsibilities which attach to being a member of the group
- Allocating responsibilities to group members – in order to:
 - Share the workload
 - Ensure all required responsibilities are discharged as required
- Providing training – in relation to:
 - Understanding the quality policies and procedures
 - Learning about required documentation
 - Identifying reporting requirements
 - Acting to ensure compliance with obligations
- Supplying necessary support to allow the effective functioning of the quality group – which may require:
 - Appointing a dedicated Training and Assessment Quality manager
 - Allocating time fractions for personnel to undertake training and assessment quality responsibilities
 - Nominating administrative support for the group
 - Providing physical resources to enable required actions to be taken

- Naming the group with an appropriate title – such as ‘Training and Assessment Quality Management Committee’ or similar
- Seeking external assistance – to advise and/or help with quality-related requirements, such as:
 - Assistance from the Training Authority – and its officers
 - Private companies with specialist expertise in Quality Management – preferably in relation to workplace training systems.



Members of the Quality Management group

Membership of the Quality Management group:

- May be specified by the Training Authority – who may (for example):
 - Nominate positions in the organisation that must be part of the group – such as the CEO
 - Stipulate positions which must be filled
 - Indicate required expertise, experience and/or qualifications of members
 - Identify the number of people in the group
- May be determined by the organisation where the workplace training system is not a recognised training provider – in this case composition of the group may include:
 - A person who is a full-time Quality Manager – or who has the responsibilities of Quality Manager allocated to them as part of their job description and workplace responsibilities
 - CEO – or representative
 - Head/Manager of the Training department
 - Trainers and assessors
 - Members of the Board of Management
 - Representatives from external providers who have contributed to establishing the QMS for the workplace training system.

Role of the group

The role of the Quality Management group/committee may be seen as:

- Providing an advisory and leadership role with respect to quality management of training and assessment across the organisation
- Preparing training and assessment plans and goals in relation to the workplace training system quality
- Aligning the quality management of the workplace training system with all relevant strategic themes and goals of the wider organisation so there is harmony between all elements of the business
- Overseeing and monitoring training and assessment quality policies and procedures
- Managing quality issues in relation to the workplace training and assessment system.

6.2 Document draft verification processes that the quality assurance group will undertake

Introduction

An initial step in the establishment of a QMS for a workplace training system is the development and documentation of draft verification processes.

This section identifies Key Activities and Goals for the elements (QA, CQI and Quality Leadership) of a QMS, and discusses considerations and activities inherent in the development of draft verification process to enable attainment of QMS goals.



Quality Assurance

Through its Quality Assurance activities the organisation ensures that all training and assessment quality requirements are met.

Key Activities

Development of communication plans

It is necessary to:

- Prepare communication plans that outline who is responsible and accountable for managing key quality assurance activities
- Identify what is required to demonstrate quality as per:
 - The standards of the Training Authority – where the workplace system is registered/accredited
 - Internal organisational standards/criteria – where the system is not registered and/or where the organisation elects to establish requirements in excess of the mandated minimum
- Share the plans with relevant stakeholders/those with responsibilities under the plan.

Development of training and assessment quality management processes

It is necessary to:

- Establish training and assessment quality management processes to satisfy internal and/or external requirements
- Prepare processes for monitoring implementation of the QMS
- Develop processes for evaluating the QMS
- Share the processes with relevant stakeholders/those who are designated to implement the processes.

Development of audit protocols

It is necessary to:

- Create a suitable and compliant audit schedule
- Prepare tools that will enable the system to systematically review its training and assessment activities
- Share the protocols with relevant stakeholders.

Goals

This sets out the verification processes the organisation/the QMS will take to achieve the goals for QA – for example, to:

- Systematically define activities necessary to ensure compliance with Training Authority obligations and registration requirements
- Systematically manage training and assessment across the organisation
- Develop formal Communications Plan to clearly articulate who is responsible and accountable for managing key QA activities and what is required to demonstrate quality in accordance with applicable standards and/or schemes/systems
- Provide resources to ensure consistency in the application of relevant internal and/or external standards and other legislated/jurisdictional requirements
- Facilitate regular, planned activities that support quality outcomes and training and assessment excellence – such as, for example:
 - Audits
 - Moderation activities
 - Validation meetings
 - Professional conversations on research
 - Training and assessment practices
- Report internally through formalised Quality Reports from training and assessment sections of the system as determined from time-to-time to monitor achievements and progress
- Appoint suitable, experienced personnel with responsibility for quality coordination
- Undertake regular, planned engagement with industry/other employer organisations to ensure learners are receiving training appropriate to the industry sector and not just the individual workplace
- Provide experiences to learners which extend beyond required course content to address 'hidden curriculum' issues such as social events and cultural activities
- Develop and review policies and procedures to ensure ongoing compliance with all applicable requirements.



Continuous Quality Improvement

Through its Continuous Quality Improvement processes the organisation is systematically reviewing its training and assessment activities and identifying improvements.

Key Activities

Develop CQI processes

It is necessary to:

- Plan processes that provide continuous quality improvement – in relation to:
 - Operational training activities
 - Operational assessment activities
 - Services to support learners and candidates
 - Training-related research
 - Practical teaching and learning
 - Relations with stakeholders
 - External partnerships and industry engagement
- Develop process to enable management of the above.



Develop risk management regime

It is necessary to prepare a risk management system which;

- Identifies training and assessment and workplace training system risks
- Evaluates risks, consequences and the possible impact of poor quality in respect:
 - The workplace system's operational activities
 - Learner and candidate support
 - Resourcing
 - Participation in/engagement with the system
 - Training-related research
 - Practical teaching and learning
 - Relations with stakeholders
 - External partnerships and industry engagement.

Goals

This sets out the verification processes the organisation/the QMS will take to achieve the goals for CQI – for example, to:

- Analyse and measure training and assessment performance of the system through the use of formal feedback with reference to:
 - Trainers and assessors
 - Learners and candidates

- Other stakeholders
- Propose improvements to the system based on the analysis of training and assessment performance
- Provide mechanisms for reporting back to trainers and assessors, learners and candidates, and other stakeholders on improvements made as a result of their feedback
- Provide tools, templates, resources, methods and materials that will ensure a consistent approach with respect to the development and continuous improvement of training and assessment materials and tasks
- Maintain a centralised repository for training and assessment materials, tools, items and resources
- Use formal Quality Reports from training and assessment areas to monitor quality improvements
- Provide a structured, formalised, system-wide complaints handling process that will ensure the effective recording, handling and resolution of complaints
- Explore options to enhance service delivery and flexibility with regard to training and assessment.



Quality leadership

Through Quality leadership the organisation is moving beyond compliance and continuous quality improvement to a space where it is aiming to set benchmarks and levels of excellence to which others will aspire.

Key Activities

Key activities in this regard may address:

- The development of new technologies, innovative pedagogies, and academically rigorous and vocationally-relevant curricula that reflect contemporary discipline-based debate and current and emerging industry needs
- Industry and stakeholder engagement and partnerships that will facilitate innovation and contemporary thought and practice
- Training and assessment staff committed to the continuous improvement of their educational programs and practice.

Goals

This sets out the verification processes the organisation/the QMS will take to achieve the goals for Quality Leadership – for example, to:

- Undertake regular network activities, industry visits/meetings or other engagements to gather feedback and establish/determine training need and content
- Develop training materials and assessment tools to suit identified content, industry need and/or organisational need

- Embrace training and assessment changes as they may relate to curriculum, competencies, technologies, industry innovation, Training Authority initiatives and/or revised standards, criteria, benchmarks or quality
- Establish and maintain strategic partnerships to create and retain relevance of the workplace training system to industry need
- Plan events and undertake initiatives to demonstrate the workplace training system commitment to corporate and social responsibility.



Considerations and activities

Objectives

Verification processes are procedures designed to:

- Capture/generate information on which to make quality-related decisions about the workplace training system
- Decide/establish the accuracy of the information captured/generated
- Determine the operational effectiveness of the workplace training system in relation to identified quality-specific topics
- Help provide information for improvement
- Demonstrate to all parties that the organisation values quality and is committed to promoting good/positive practices
- Protect the standards the workplace training system has espoused and seeks to achieve.

Verification processes:

- Are sometimes referred to as 'Verification and Validation processes'
- May be contained in a dedicated QA handbook
- May be applied internally – by the organisation itself
- May be undertaken by external authorities or bodies.

Options

It is possible the workplace training system may:

- Use the services of an external professional business – to provide its QA-related schemes and processes through an appropriate and recognised QA scheme requiring the organisation to gain and retain accreditation in order to remain compliant.

This is an option for registered/accredited training providers.

- Implement the QA scheme/practices used elsewhere in the organisation for other operational aspects of the business.

This is also an option for registered/accredited training providers.

- Apply the QA scheme and/or process prescribed by the Training Authority – where the system is a registered/accredited one.
- Not use any QA protocols at all – where the system is not a registered/accredited one.

Establishment activities

Activities which should guide the development of draft verification processes to enable attainment of the stated goals may include:

- Seeking input from key stakeholders – to ensure all required topics/areas are covered by the processes and addressed to the depth and satisfaction necessary
- Utilising existing processes from external third party providers – as provided for under the schemes they provide/sell to the organisation
- Generating enterprise specific processes – in accordance with identified workplace need
- Validating the quality assurance processes – and confirming their applicability to individual workplace need
- Supplying members of the QA group/Quality Management group with copies of the established processes – so they can become familiar with their requirements
- Notifying other key stakeholders, as appropriate – to advise and communicate the tenor of the QA processes to be applied.



Possible focus for QA procedures

Quality assurance procedures may address/include:

- Conduct of regular activities – such as:
 - Evaluations
 - Reviews
 - Audits
- Mandatory professional development requirements – for:
 - Trainers
 - Assessors
 - Resource writers
- Focus on nominated elements of the system – such as:
 - Training delivery and training methods/strategies used
 - Assessment methods used to determine the 'C' or 'NYC' decision
 - Evidence used to make the 'C' or 'NYC' decision
 - Analysis of 'C' or 'NYC' assessment decisions made
 - Access and equity issues
 - Record keeping and record management
 - Documentation (plans, tools, assessment items) used to support, enable and underpin training and assessment activities
 - Reporting
 - Resources and training/assessment materials used

- Training and assessment staff competencies – including training-related competencies and workplace operational competencies
 - Training competencies/content – to ensure they are current and reflect actual/identified need
 - Compliance with on-going registration requirements imposed by national Training Authority and the Standards they prescribe
 - Engaging with learners and stakeholders to maintain relevance of training and assessment and to keep them informed
 - Provision of feedback, results and system-related information to learners, candidates and stakeholders
 - Support provided to learners and candidates
 - Training and assessment-related policies and procedures
- Modifications to the training system – based on:
 - Evaluations, reviews and audits
 - Complaints, appeals and grievances
 - Requirements as a result of internal and/or external imperatives imposed by (for example) organisational plans, national Training Authority, or legislation.
 - Promotion of networking amongst trainers and assessors.



Practical documentation activities

It is recommended to:

- Use a team approach to generate the processes – using the skills of the QA group/Quality Management group and co-opting others as required
- Use templates and *pro formas* as the basis for documentation – to provide consistency and standardisation
- Write applying clear and direct language which is understood by users – as opposed to preparing ‘academic’ documents
- Obtain sample documentations if possible from other workplace training systems – to use as a model/basis for writing draft processes
- Strive to make the processes user-friendly and not overly complicated or onerous – many workplace training systems become disenfranchised with QA processes because they sometimes appear to be of ‘more importance’ (and/or take up more time) than the primary focus of the system in terms of the provision of training and assessment
- Apply version control protocols – to control iterations of teach process
- Determine schedule for the development processes – in relation to:
 - Production of drafts
 - Trialling of drafts – see next section
- Allocate responsibilities – for implementing the processes.

6.3 Trial the draft quality assurance procedures

Introduction

It is standard practice for draft QA procedures to be trialled before they are approved for general use.

This section presents and discusses activities inherent in the trialling and testing process.



Activities involved

Trialling draft quality assurance procedures may include/require:

- Submitting draft processes to stakeholders for pre-trial feedback – even though a team approach may have been used to develop the draft processes, distributing drafts for pre-trial comment can save lots of time
- Obtaining initial authorisation to proceed with the trial – this may be a requirement given implementation of QA processes can cost a significant amount in terms of time and money as well as considerable disruption to standard day-to-day work activities
- Communicating the draft processes – to those who have been allocated responsibilities for applying the processes
- Conducting training with staff – so they have base competency with implementing the processes they have been allocated
- Scheduling the trials – with aims of:
 - Accommodating standard operational imperatives of the organisation and the Training department
 - Ensuring all contributors are paid to participate/engage with the initiative
 - Integrating the demands of the initiative within the other obligations imposed on respondents
- Implementing the draft process – strictly in accordance with the drafted instructions
- Involving representatives of the national Training Authority and/or the body operating the system in the trials – if the training system is recognised and if they are willing to participate
- Capturing required information – as prescribed/identified by the individual processes and as provided by respondents or the data/records being assessed
- Noting points which have arisen during the trial – which need to be accommodated as part of the review and revision parts of the procedure
- Reviewing implementation of draft verification processes – using:
 - The data obtained
 - Feedback provided by respondents
 - A team approach
 - Representatives from the national Training Authority and/or the body operating the system

- Revising draft quality assurance procedures as necessary – on the basis of feedback and trial implementation
- Making submissions for approval of final documents – for example, submissions for approval of:
 - Revised drafts
 - New processes produced on the basis of the trials
- Determining operating schedule – for implementation of the processes
- Circulating the final/approved processes – to all stakeholders.



6.4 Advise trainers in relation to established and confirmed quality assurance procedures

Introduction

When all quality assurance processes have been finalised and approved there is a need to ensure all trainers and assessors are made aware of those procedures.

This section identifies the need to advise trainers and assessors in this regard and indicates how this advice may be communicated.

Need to advise staff

There is a need to advise trainers and assessors regarding QA processes that will be used so:

- They understand how their performance will (in part) be evaluated – and this often removes fear, worry and concern about the process
- They gain greater appreciation of registration/accreditation and compliance requirements – which helps them better understand the overall system they are working within
- They know the areas of their work which are subject to targeted analysis/evaluation – and so they can focus their efforts to ensure these areas receive suitable attention and effort
- The organisation and/or the Training Authority demonstrates openness and transparency – rather than judging/evaluating them on ‘secret’ criteria
- They can locate Quality Management better – within the overall context of the operations of the organisation and the training system
- They realise other trainers and assessors in other workplace training systems are also subject to the same/similar processes – and they are not being targeted or victimised.

Ways to advise staff

Standard ways to advise trainers and assessors regarding established and confirmed QA/QMS processes are a combination of the following:

- Provision of copies of relevant documents – these can include:
 - Policies and procedures
 - General advice and information
 - Schedules and time-tables for implementation
 - Roles and responsibilities
 - Operational documentation – recording sheets, checklists, questionnaires, interview sheets, product analysis sheets

Copies may/should be hard copy and soft copy versions



- Verbal explanations featuring contributions by the Quality management team/group and representatives from the national Training Authority and/or relevant other bodies – highlighting:
 - Rationale for implementation
 - Consequences of failing to implement as required
 - The development process
 - Use which will be made of the data/results/findings
 - Roles and responsibilities
 - Time allocations
 - Resources to support/enable implementation
- Formal training – including:
 - Presentation of knowledge/information about the processes
 - Demonstrations of implementing requirements
 - Role plays
 - Case studies
 - Drill and practical exercises and demonstrations.



Work Projects

It is a requirement of this Unit you complete Work Projects as advised by your Trainer. You must submit documentation, suitable evidence or other relevant proof of completion of the project to your Trainer by the agreed date.

Note: this Work Project follows from the previous Work Project.

6.1 For the organisation/workplace identified in Work Project 1.1 establish quality assurance procedures for the workplace training system providing evidence you have:

- Established a quality assurance group
 - Documented draft verification processes that the quality assurance group will undertake
 - Trialled the draft quality assurance procedures
 - Advised trainers in relation to established and confirmed quality assurance procedures.
-

Summary

Establish quality assurance procedures for the workplace training system

When establishing quality assurance procedures for the workplace training system:

- Establish a group to manage quality in the system
- Integrate quality management of the training system with management of quality in other areas
- Comply with externally imposed requirements
- Explain and promote the need for Quality Management of the system
- Involve stakeholders in the development of quality procedures
- Base organisational quality processes on those used by other providers and/or models provided by the Training Authority
- Draft, trial and revise quality procedures
- Formally document all quality procedures
- Notify stakeholders of approved/confirmed procedures
- Provide training in implementation of quality procedures.

Presentation of written work

1. Introduction

It is important for students to present carefully prepared written work. Written presentation in industry must be professional in appearance and accurate in content. If students develop good writing skills whilst studying, they are able to easily transfer those skills to the workplace.

2. Style



Students should write in a style that is simple and concise. Short sentences and paragraphs are easier to read and understand. It helps to write a plan and at least one draft of the written work so that the final product will be well organised. The points presented will then follow a logical sequence and be relevant. Students should frequently refer to the question asked, to keep 'on track'. Teachers recognise and are critical of work that does not answer the question, or is 'padded' with irrelevant material. In summary, remember to:

- Plan ahead
- Be clear and concise
- Answer the question
- Proofread the final draft.

3. Presenting Written Work

Types of written work

Students may be asked to write:

- Short and long reports
- Essays
- Records of interviews
- Questionnaires
- Business letters
- Resumes.



Format

All written work should be presented on A4 paper, single-sided with a left-hand margin. If work is word-processed, one-and-a-half or double spacing should be used. Handwritten work must be legible and should also be well spaced to allow for ease of reading. New paragraphs should not be indented but should be separated by a space. Pages must be numbered. If headings are also to be numbered, students should use a logical and sequential system of numbering.

Cover Sheet

All written work should be submitted with a cover sheet stapled to the front that contains:

- The student's name and student number
- The name of the class/unit
- The due date of the work
- The title of the work
- The teacher's name
- A signed declaration that the work does not involve plagiarism.

Keeping a Copy

Students must keep a copy of the written work in case it is lost. This rarely happens but it can be disastrous if a copy has not been kept.

Inclusive language

This means language that includes every section of the population. For instance, if a student were to write 'A nurse is responsible for the patients in her care at all times' it would be implying that all nurses are female and would be excluding male nurses.

Examples of appropriate language are shown on the right:

Mankind	<i>Humankind</i>
Barman/maid	<i>Bar attendant</i>
Host/hostess	<i>Host</i>
Waiter/waitress	<i>Waiter or waiting staff</i>

Recommended reading

Note: all Recommended Reading is sourced from 'Trove: National Library of Australia' at <http://trove.nla.gov.au/>.

Branton, Kevin David 2015, *Human resource management and contextual ambidexterity: an individual level analysis*, Monash University. Faculty of Business and Economics. Department of Management

Domjan, Michael & Grau, James W 2015, *Principles of learning and behavior*, 7th ed, Cengage Learning, Stamford, CT

Hager, Paul (ed) & Lee, Alison (ed) & Reich, Ann (ed) 2012, 'Practice, learning and change : practice-theory perspectives on professional learning' (*Professional and practice-based learning ; n.8*)

Harris, Roger, (editor of compilation.) & Short, Tom, (editor of compilation.) 2015, *Workforce development: perspectives and issues*, New York Springer

Lussier, Robert N 2015, *Management fundamentals: concepts, applications, & skill development*, Sixth edition, Thousand Oaks, California SAGE

Marchington, Mick & Wilkinson, Adrian John 2013-09-30, *Human Resource Management at Work: People Management and Development*, http://www.cipd.co.uk/Bookstore/_catalogue/HRPractice/9781843982678.htm, http

Nankervis, Alan R & Baird, Marian, (author.) & Coffey, Jane, (author.) & Shields, John, (author.) 2015, *Human resource management: strategy and practice*, Eighth edition, South Melbourne, Victoria Cengage Learning Australia

Nik Mat, Nik Hazimah, Dr 2015-01-01, *The HRM role of line managers: A Malaysian case study*, Research Online

Wild, John J & Wild, Kenneth L & Ball, Alverne 2016, *International business: the challenges of globalization*, Eighth Edition, Upper Saddle River Pearson

Trainee evaluation sheet

Design and establish a training system

The following statements are about the competency you have just completed.

Please tick the appropriate box	Agree	Don't Know	Do Not Agree	Does Not Apply
There was too much in this competency to cover without rushing.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Most of the competency seemed relevant to me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency was at the right level for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I got enough help from my trainer.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The amount of activities was sufficient.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The competency allowed me to use my own initiative.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My training was well-organised.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer had time to answer my questions.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I understood how I was going to be assessed.	☐	☐	☐	☐
I was given enough time to practice.	☐	☐	☐	☐
My trainer feedback was useful.	☐	☐	☐	☐
Enough equipment was available and it worked well.	☐	☐	☐	☐
The activities were too hard for me.	☐	☐	☐	☐

The best things about this unit were:

The worst things about this unit were:

The things you should change in this unit are:

Trainee self-assessment checklist

As an indicator to your Trainer/Assessor of your readiness for assessment in this unit please complete the following and hand to your Trainer/Assessor.

Design and establish a training system

		Yes	No*
Element 1: Determine the features of a workplace training system			
1.1	Identify key operational features and constraints of the workplace training system	☐	☐
1.2	Research enterprise requirements in relation to the workplace training system	☐	☐
1.3	Identify the legal and other requirements that apply to the establishment and operation of the workplace training system	☐	☐
1.4	Document and verify identified operational features and constraints of the workplace training system	☐	☐
1.5	Establish and maintain relationships with key stakeholders	☐	☐
1.6	Identify the resources available to support the identified workplace training system requirements	☐	☐
Element 2: Align workplace training needs with required resources			
2.1	Match human resources to identified workplace training needs	☐	☐
2.2	Match physical resources to identified workplace training needs	☐	☐
2.3	Match financial resources to identified workplace training needs	☐	☐
2.4	Identify external funding sources for the workplace training system	☐	☐
2.5	Prepare a budget for the workplace training system	☐	☐
2.6	Obtain management commitment to the workplace training system	☐	☐
2.7	Identify sources of provision for workplace training materials and delivery	☐	☐

		Yes	No*
Element 3: Develop workplace training system documents			
3.1	Develop training policies and procedures to support implementation and operation of the workplace training system	☐	☐
3.2	Identify record keeping requirements within the identified workplace training system	☐	☐
3.3	Produce operational training system forms to support and record workplace training delivery	☐	☐
Element 4: Establish procedures for the review of the workplace training system			
4.1	Identify the elements of the workplace training system to be reviewed	☐	☐
4.2	Determine the frequency for reviewing identified elements within the workplace training system	☐	☐
4.3	Allocate responsibility for implementing identified reviews of the workplace training system	☐	☐
4.4	Describe the procedures to be used in the review of the workplace training system	☐	☐
4.5	Document approved procedures for review of the workplace training system	☐	☐
4.6	Obtain management commitment to implement required changes to the workplace training system	☐	☐
Element 5: Prepare to implement the workplace training system			
5.1	Develop an implementation plan for the training system	☐	☐
5.2	Prepare trainers and assessors in accordance with identified need	☐	☐
5.3	Prepare training programs to provide identified training	☐	☐
5.4	Obtain resources to support training delivery	☐	☐
5.5	Recruit participants for training	☐	☐
Element 6: Establish quality assurance procedures for the workplace training system			
6.1	Establish a quality assurance group	☐	☐
6.2	Document draft verification processes that the quality assurance group will undertake	☐	☐
6.3	Trial the draft quality assurance procedures	☐	☐
6.4	Advise trainers in relation to established and confirmed quality assurance procedures	☐	☐

Statement by Trainee:

I believe I am ready to be assessed on the following as indicated above:

Signed: _____

Date: _____

Note:

For all boxes where a **No*** is ticked, please provide details of the extra steps or work you need to do to become ready for assessment.

